

ENGLISH FOR EARLY-YEARS TEAMS

Childcare and Early Education English

Warm communication. Clear care.



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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For early-years educators, nursery staff, preschool assistants, and childcare teams working with children and families.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight early-years cases: arrivals, shared play, transitions, peer disagreements, learning observations, inclusive participation, health plans, and collection checks.

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Be specific, warm, and fair.

Early-years communication moves between brief child-facing phrases and detailed discussions with families and colleagues. Describe what happened, offer genuine choices, preserve the child perspective, and keep important care arrangements clear.

Describe before interpreting

A recorded action and a guessed motive are different. Name what you saw and heard without turning one moment into a fixed label for the child or a comparison unsupported by evidence.

"Eli sorted four buttons by color and said, These go together."

Make a choice real

Offer options that are genuinely available within the current plan. A choice between two ways to finish a transition is not permission to keep playing indefinitely. Keep the boundary calm and predictable.

"You can place the last block or ask for a permitted photograph before story time."

Recognize more than one way to join in

A child may participate through pointing, gesture, or speech when the activity and plan allow it. Describe the response accurately rather than treating silence as absence or claiming every format supplies identical evidence.

"Noor selected a picture by pointing; no spoken answer was recorded."

Name the responsible next step

A health-plan query or unverified collection arrangement needs an appropriate owner and the real center procedure. Respectful communication does not require improvising a safety decision or accusing a person without evidence.

"Rosa is checking the collection arrangement; authority is not yet verified."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All children, families, centers, and cases are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not childcare licensing, clinical advice, developmental diagnosis, or safeguarding certification. Follow current local law, supervision requirements, individual plans, and center procedures. Do not delay urgent safeguarding or emergency action for a routine query. Materials and activities require age-appropriate risk assessment. England and US sources provide distinct contexts, not interchangeable legal rules.

Agreeing on the goodbye

A Read the situation

Clarify conflicting arrival expectations with a parent while keeping the child's needs and responsible educator visible.

It is Mina's third morning at the center. Parent Daniel expected to stay for ten minutes, but the arrival note says a brief goodbye. Key educator Rosa is present and can clarify the settling-in plan with Daniel. Mina has a familiar cloth; using it must follow the center arrangements. No fixed departure time or guaranteed emotional response is established. Rosa must acknowledge the difference, avoid blaming Daniel or labeling Mina as difficult, and clarify the plan before giving inconsistent directions.

PEOPLE / Daniel: Mina's parent | Rosa: Key educator

A PARTNERSHIP STARTS WITH LISTENING

Parents and staff may attach different meanings to a brief goodbye. Acknowledge the expectation without promising an arrangement before it is clarified. The child should hear calm, consistent language rather than adults correcting one another sharply at the door.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What did Daniel expect?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A To stay for ten minutes | B To leave without speaking to anyone |
| C A guaranteed distress-free arrival | D A new collection arrangement |

2. Who can clarify the plan?

- | | |
|---|------------------------------------|
| A Another parent without responsibility | B Mina alone |
| C An invented policy unrelated to the center | D Rosa, Mina's key educator |

3. What is not established?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A A fixed departure time and guaranteed emotional response | B That it is Mina's third morning |
| C That Mina has a familiar cloth | D That the arrival note says brief goodbye |

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

settling-in plan

Agreed approach helping a child become familiar with a setting and its people.

IN USE clarify the settling-in plan

key educator

Staff member with particular responsibility for supporting a child and family.

IN USE speak with the key educator

arrival routine

Usual sequence when a child enters the setting.

IN USE establish an arrival routine

family partnership

Working relationship in which families and educators share relevant knowledge.

IN USE build a family partnership

handover

Transfer of relevant information and care responsibility between people.

IN USE complete the morning handover

brief goodbye

Short departure exchange whose practical meaning needs agreement.

IN USE agree on a brief goodbye

familiar object

Known item that may offer continuity or comfort within permitted arrangements.

IN USE discuss a familiar object

comfort item

Object associated with reassurance, used under appropriate safety arrangements.

IN USE check comfort-item arrangements

separation

Period or event in which a child and familiar caregiver are apart.

IN USE support separation

reassurance

Supportive communication intended to reduce uncertainty or concern.

IN USE offer realistic reassurance

attachment

Enduring emotional connection with a familiar caregiver or other significant person.

IN USE support attachment relationships

responsive care

Care that notices and responds appropriately to the child's cues.

IN USE provide responsive care

Precision check

Brief is not a universal number of minutes. Here it conflicts with Daniel expecting ten minutes, so the plan needs clarification. Do not convert either source into a finalized agreement before Rosa and Daniel resolve the practical meaning.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

child cue

Observable signal of a child's interest, need, or emotional state.

IN USE notice a child cue

predictability

Quality of an arrangement being understandable and reasonably consistent.

IN USE build predictability

consistency

Alignment of actions or messages across people or occasions.

IN USE maintain consistency

parent expectation

What a parent believes will happen in the arrangement.

IN USE clarify the parent expectation

arrival note

Recorded information about the child's arrival or agreed approach.

IN USE review the arrival note

agreed wording

Language adults have decided to use consistently.

IN USE use agreed wording

transition support

Help with moving between people, settings, or activities.

IN USE provide transition support

emotional response

Feelings or reactions expressed in a situation.

IN USE observe the emotional response

individual need

Requirement specific to a particular child rather than an assumed group norm.

IN USE respond to individual needs

update arrangement

Agreed method or time for sharing later information.

IN USE clarify the update arrangement

contact preference

Preferred communication method where appropriate and authorized.

IN USE confirm contact preferences

shared understanding

Agreement about what a plan or message means.

IN USE establish shared understanding

Precision check

A familiar cloth may support continuity, but its use depends on actual safety and center arrangements. Do not present a comfort item as automatically suitable for every age, activity, or sleep setting, and do not promise it will prevent distress.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE EXPECTATION

"You expected to stay for ten minutes."

NAME THE DIFFERENCE

"Those expectations need to be clarified together."

KEEP THE CHILD CENTRAL

"Let us keep our messages to Mina calm and consistent."

REJECT A GUARANTEE GENTLY

"I cannot promise exactly how Mina will respond."

READ THE NOTE NEUTRALLY

"The arrival note says a brief goodbye."

IDENTIFY THE RESPONSIBLE ADULT

"I am Mina's key educator, and we can clarify the plan."

AVOID BLAME

"We do not need to decide who is at fault to clarify this."

NOTICE THE FAMILIAR ITEM

"Mina has brought her familiar cloth."

You expected

Recognizes the parent's understanding without declaring it the final plan.

The note says

Attributes the other message rather than using it as an accusation.

Together

Frames clarification as cooperation instead of correction of the parent.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK THE ARRANGEMENT

"Its use needs to follow our center arrangements."

INVITE USEFUL INFORMATION

"Please tell me what you expected the goodbye to involve."

KEEP SUPPORT CONCRETE

"Mina needs to know which adult is receiving her."

CLARIFY LATER CONTACT

"Any update arrangement should be agreed rather than assumed."

DO NOT INVENT A DEADLINE

"We have not yet agreed on a departure time here."

PRESERVE THE PLAN

"We should record the clarified arrangement through our process."

AVOID A FIXED LABEL

"One arrival does not define Mina as a difficult child."

CLOSE TOGETHER

"Let us confirm the plan and use the same message with Mina."

Exactly how

Limits promises about the child's feelings.

Not yet agreed

Prevents a possible arrangement from becoming a confirmed instruction.

Same message

Connects adult coordination with the child's experience.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which opening is most useful?

- A** A brief goodbye guarantees no tears.
- B** You expected ten minutes; the note says brief goodbye. Let us clarify the plan together.
- C** You are making Mina difficult by staying.
- D** Ten minutes is mandatory in every center.

2. What should be said about the cloth?

- A** Approval during arrival automatically extends to sleep.
- B** A parent's usual home practice replaces the center's safety checks.
- C** Keeping it nearby confirms Mina will not become upset.
- D** Its use follows the center's actual arrangements.

3. Why should adults coordinate their wording?

- A** To hide the parent expectation
- B** To avoid ever recording a change
- C** To make the child choose which adult is right
- D** To give Mina a calm, consistent message about the clarified plan

4. Which statement overreaches?

- A** Mina will definitely be calm as soon as Daniel leaves.
- B** It is Mina's third morning.
- C** Rosa is present.
- D** The departure time is not yet agreed here.

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

Agreeing on the goodbye

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

settling-in plan / consistency / comfort item / key educator / update arrangement / emotional response / family partnership / brief goodbye / arrival routine / shared understanding

- 01 **Daniel:** Rosa, I thought I could stay for ten minutes this morning, but the note says a brief goodbye. I do not want Mina hearing two different instructions.
- 02 **Rosa:** Thank you for raising that. We need to clarify the ¹ _____ together. The note and your expectation do not yet give us one agreed approach.
- 03 **Daniel:** It is only her third morning, and I had prepared her for me staying a little while. I am worried about changing the message at the door.
- 04 **Rosa:** I am her ² _____, so let us work through the difference calmly. We should not make Mina choose between what you expected and what the note appears to say.
- 05 **Daniel:** When staff say brief, do they mean a particular number of minutes? I cannot tell whether ten minutes fits that word or contradicts it.
- 06 **Rosa:** A ³ _____ needs a clear meaning in our arrangement. I should not treat that word as though we have already agreed on an exact departure time.
- 07 **Daniel:** Yesterday I was told not to rush. This morning the note sounds different. I need to know what to do, and Mina is listening to us.
- 08 **Rosa:** This is about ⁴ _____, not blame. We can acknowledge what you understood and clarify the plan without labeling your choice as the cause of a reaction we have not observed.
- 09 **Daniel:** She has brought her familiar cloth. It helps her recognize something from home, but I do not know the center arrangements for using it.
- 10 **Rosa:** We should check the ⁵ _____ arrangements. Its familiarity is useful information, but I will not assume it can be used in every activity or setting.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Daniel:** Could you promise that she will be settled after I leave? I know that may be difficult to answer, but it would make leaving easier.
- 12 **Rosa:** I can offer honest support, not a guaranteed ⁶ _____. We will need to notice how Mina responds and follow the agreed approach rather than promise a particular feeling.
- 13 **Daniel:** Could you be the person she comes to after our goodbye? She knows you now, and I would like to tell her who will be with her.
- 14 **Rosa:** Agreed. A consistent ⁷ _____ should make the next step understandable. Let us clarify the practical handover and use the same message with her.
- 15 **Daniel:** Will tomorrow's staff see what we agree? I do not want to prepare Mina for one routine and be given a different instruction when we arrive.
- 16 **Rosa:** Yes. We should preserve the ⁸ _____ through our process. A clear record will help colleagues continue the arrangement without inventing a new version.
- 17 **Daniel:** And how will I hear how she gets on? I keep checking my phone, but I do not know when I should expect an update.
- 18 **Rosa:** We can clarify the ⁹ _____ as part of the conversation. We should say what contact is genuinely agreed rather than leave you waiting for an assumed promise.
- 19 **Daniel:** Thank you. My main concern is that Mina gets one calm message and that I understand the plan before being told to leave.
- 20 **Rosa:** That is why ¹⁰ _____ matters here. Let us resolve the expectation, confirm the handover, and keep the message to Mina clear and respectful.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. settling-in plan | 2. key educator | 3. brief goodbye | 4. family partnership | 5. comfort item | 6. emotional response | 7. arrival routine | 8. shared understanding | 9. update arrangement | 10. consistency

Clarify another arrival mismatch

F Say it

Parent Ellis expects a five-minute stay. The note says immediate handover. Key educator Noor is present. No revised agreement has been made.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Noor / immediate handover / five-minute / confirmed

Ellis: "I expected a ¹ _____ stay."

Noor: "The note says ² _____."

Ellis: "The key educator available is ³ _____."

Noor: "The revised agreement is not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. five-minute | 2. immediate handover | 3. Noor | 4. confirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Daniel and Rosa's checked dialogue. Contrast expected ten minutes with the note's brief goodbye without blaming the parent.
2. Switch roles. Repeat the handover and update questions, keeping every unconfirmed arrangement conditional.
3. Complete the five-minute/immediate-handover transfer, check the key, then read it without inventing a revised agreement.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two bridge ideas

A Read the situation

Use neutral prompts and comparative language to support shared investigation without choosing a winner for the children.

During fictional block play, Eva and Jo each want their bridge design used. Eva wants a wider bridge; Jo wants a taller opening underneath. Educators Maya and Ben discuss language that will invite both explanations and support trying two designs with the available blocks. No winner has been chosen, and no test outcome is supplied. The task is to model useful child-facing phrases inside an adult planning conversation. A prompt should leave room for the child idea without quietly supplying the answer or making the activity a competition.

PEOPLE / Maya: Early-years educator | Ben: Colleague supporting block play

CURIOSITY CAN BE PRECISE

An educator can give language support without taking ownership of the design. Name width and height clearly, allow both ideas to be expressed, and avoid praise that makes one child the winner before the structures have been explored.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does Eva want?

- | | |
|--|--------------------------|
| A A taller opening as her only stated aim | B A chosen winner |
| C A completed adult design | D A wider bridge |

2. What does Jo want?

- | | |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A Removal of all blocks | B A fixed winning score |
| C A guaranteed wider deck | D A taller opening underneath |

3. What can the educators suggest?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Declare Eva the winner immediately. | B Claim both tests have already succeeded. |
| C Supply unavailable materials as though they are present. | D Try two designs using the available blocks. |

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

play-based learning

Learning developed through purposeful opportunities for play and exploration.

IN USE support play-based learning

child-led idea

Proposal originating with the child rather than prescribed by an adult.

IN USE follow a child-led idea

adult scaffolding

Temporary support that helps a learner do more while retaining meaningful participation.

IN USE provide adult scaffolding

open prompt

Invitation allowing a range of relevant responses rather than supplying one answer.

IN USE use an open prompt

leading question

Question that steers the listener toward an implied preferred answer.

IN USE avoid a leading question

wait time

Deliberate pause allowing a child time to process and respond.

IN USE allow wait time

sustained shared thinking

Extended joint exploration of an idea or problem through interaction.

IN USE support sustained shared thinking

modeling

Demonstrating language or action that can support learning.

IN USE use language modeling

recasting

Restating a child's message with an adjusted grammatical form while preserving the intended meaning.

IN USE use a gentle recast

expansion

Adding useful language to a child's expressed idea while preserving its meaning.

IN USE offer a language expansion

comparative language

Words used to describe relative qualities such as wider or taller.

IN USE model comparative language

spatial language

Words describing position, direction, distance, or arrangement.

IN USE introduce spatial language

Precision check

Wider and taller refer to different dimensions. A bridge can be wide without having a tall opening. Preserve each child design intention before suggesting a comparison, and do not change taller into better or wider into stronger without evidence.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

width

Measurement across an object from side to side.

IN USE compare bridge width

height

Vertical measurement from a defined lower point to a higher point.

IN USE compare opening height

span

Distance bridged between supports.

IN USE compare the span

support

Part holding up or stabilizing a structure.

IN USE position the supports

stability

Ability of a structure to remain in position under relevant conditions.

IN USE explore stability

clearance

Space available between an object and a surrounding or overhead surface.

IN USE check the clearance

design intention

What the maker wants a design to do or achieve.

IN USE clarify the design intention

prediction

Statement about what someone expects to happen before trying it.

IN USE make a prediction

trial

Attempt used to explore how something works.

IN USE compare two trials

revision

Change made to a design or idea after further thinking or testing.

IN USE revise the design

collaborative play

Play involving coordination or shared activity with others.

IN USE support collaborative play

specific feedback

Response naming an observed action or feature rather than general praise alone.

IN USE give specific feedback

Precision check

An open prompt invites the child idea; a leading question suggests the adult answer. Comparing structures is different from ranking children. Useful feedback names an observed feature, while a prediction remains an expectation until the relevant trial has occurred.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

INVITE EVA'S IDEA

"Eva, show us what you mean by a wider bridge."

NAME BOTH PRIORITIES

"Eva is exploring width, and Jo is exploring opening height."

OFFER A FEASIBLE TRIAL

"We can try two designs with these available blocks."

ASK WITHOUT SUPPLYING

"What do you want this part of the bridge to do?"

INVITE JO'S IDEA

"Jo, show us where you want the taller opening."

AVOID A WINNER

"We have two ideas to try, not a winner already chosen."

MODEL COMPARISON

"This opening is taller; this bridge is wider."

ALLOW PROCESSING

"I will pause so each child has time to respond."

Show us what you mean

Allows gesture and demonstration alongside words.

Where

Directs attention to the relevant part without prescribing the design.

Two ideas to try

Frames the activity as exploration rather than a contest.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PRESERVE THE IDEA

"I can expand the language without replacing the child's intention."

GIVE SPECIFIC FEEDBACK

"You moved the supports farther apart."

KEEP THE ACTIVITY SHARED

"Let us hear both explanations before choosing what to try."

INVITE A REVISION

"You can change the design after seeing what happens."

SEPARATE PREDICTION AND RESULT

"That is what you expect; now we can see what happens."

USE SPATIAL LANGUAGE

"The opening is underneath the bridge."

AVOID AN UNSUPPORTED CLAIM

"A wider design is not automatically the stronger one."

CLOSE WITH EXPLORATION

"We can compare the two designs without ranking the children."

What do you want

Keeps the intention with the child.

Expect versus happens

Separates prediction from observation.

Ranking the children

Distinguishes comparing structures from labeling children's ability.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which prompt preserves Jo's idea?

- A You really mean a wider bridge, do you not?
- B Eva's idea is better, so copy it.
- C A tall opening always wins.
- D Show us where you want the taller opening.

2. Which sentence is a leading question?

- A Which feature are you describing?
- B Wouldn't it be better to use my wider design?
- C What do you want this part to do?
- D Show us where the opening would be.

3. Which comparison is factual in principle?

- A This bridge is wider, while that opening is taller.
- B The child with the taller design is more intelligent.
- C The wider bridge is always strongest.
- D Both designs have already passed every test.

4. What is the proposed next action?

- A Promise that neither structure can fall.
- B Require a material that is not available.
- C Try two designs using available blocks.
- D Announce a winner before exploration.

Answers and explanations: page 87.

Two bridge ideas

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Comparative language / expansion / trial / wait time / collaborative play / open prompt / leading question / design intention / specific feedback / spatial language

- 01 **Ben:** Eva and Jo both want their bridge idea used. Eva wants it wider, while Jo keeps showing me a taller opening underneath. I am tempted to choose one.
- 02 **Maya:** Let us clarify each ¹ _____ first. We can ask Eva to show the width and Jo to show the opening, without deciding whose idea is better.
- 03 **Ben:** I could say, "Eva, show us what you mean by wider." That lets her point or demonstrate rather than requiring a long explanation.
- 04 **Maya:** Yes. That is an ² _____. It supports her idea without putting our answer into her mouth or turning the exchange into a vocabulary test.
- 05 **Ben:** For Jo, I could ask where the opening should be taller. I should not translate his request into another version of Eva's idea.
- 06 **Maya:** Exactly. Use ³ _____ such as underneath while keeping the idea his. Height of an opening and width of a bridge are different features.
- 07 **Ben:** I caught myself saying, "Wouldn't a wider bridge be better?" That was really my idea in question form. I need to give Jo's opening a fair hearing too.
- 08 **Maya:** That is a ⁴ _____. It could make Jo feel that the decision is already made. We can invite explanations without hinting which child should agree with us.
- 09 **Ben:** We have blocks available for trying two designs. I could suggest that practical option instead of making the children compete for one approved plan.
- 10 **Maya:** A second ⁵ _____ gives us something to compare. We should not announce the result in advance or promise that a particular structure will work.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Ben:** I keep saying good job, but it does not give them much to work with. What could I say about the supports they are moving?
- 12 **Maya:** Offer ⁶ _____. such as, "You moved the supports farther apart." That names an action and leaves room for the child to explain what they intended.
- 13 **Ben:** I can also model wider and taller while pointing to the appropriate dimension. I should not use taller as another word for better.
- 14 **Maya:** Right. ⁷ _____ helps describe the structures. It should not quietly become a ranking of the children or an unsupported claim about strength.
- 15 **Ben:** If Eva says, "More space here," I might say, "You want more space across the bridge," while checking that I have kept her meaning.
- 16 **Maya:** That is a useful ⁸ _____. We are adding language around her idea, not correcting her into a different design or requiring her to repeat our exact sentence.
- 17 **Ben:** I tend to fill the silence. Eva may be about to point when I jump in with another question. I will try leaving that space.
- 18 **Maya:** Allow ⁹ _____. Watch their responses, including gestures, and keep the exploration moving at a pace that allows both to participate.
- 19 **Ben:** Then our plan is to hear both intentions, offer two available-block trials, and describe what happens without choosing a winner beforehand.
- 20 **Maya:** Yes. That supports ¹⁰ _____. We can compare features, invite a later revision, and keep the children's ideas at the center of the conversation.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. design intention | 2. open prompt | 3. spatial language | 4. leading question | 5. trial | 6. specific feedback | 7. Comparative language | 8. expansion | 9. wait time | 10. collaborative play

Compare two tower intentions

F Say it

Ari wants a wider tower base. Bea wants a taller tower. Available blocks allow two trials. No winner or result is established.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

winner / taller / wider / trials

Educator: "Ari wants a ¹ _____ base."

Colleague: "Bea wants a ² _____ tower."

Educator: "We can offer two ³ _____."

Colleague: "No ⁴ _____ has been chosen."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. wider | 2. taller | 3. trials | 4. winner

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Maya and Ben's corrected dialogue. Use your voice to distinguish a wider bridge from a taller opening.
2. Switch roles. Read the exact child-facing prompts, pausing after each prompt instead of supplying a child's answer.
3. Complete the tower comparison, check the key, then read it aloud without changing wider, taller, or the two proposed trials.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Five minutes to story time

A Read the situation

03

Offer bounded choices and a predictable next step without turning a transition into an open-ended negotiation.

Luca is building when the room will move to story time in five minutes. The current center arrangement allows the structure to remain on the marked shelf. Luca can choose to place the last block or ask the educator for a photograph using the center permitted practice. Educators Nora and Ben discuss how to explain these options. They cannot extend play indefinitely, promise a return time that is not supplied, or use a personal device outside the approved photography arrangements. The choices concern how to finish, not whether story time happens.

PEOPLE / Nora: Early-years educator | Ben: Colleague coordinating the transition

A BOUNDARY AND A CHOICE CAN COEXIST

A genuine choice can help a child finish an activity without removing the next routine. State the shared boundary first, then offer the available options in simple language. Avoid asking a yes-or-no question when no is not an available outcome.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which timing statement is supplied by the arrangement?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Luca has five minutes after the group starts story time. | B The photograph postpones the group transition. |
| C Story time begins in five minutes. | D Building resumes immediately after the story. |

2. What can remain on the marked shelf?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A An unapproved personal camera | B A guaranteed future activity slot |
| C Luca's structure under the current arrangement | D Every object permanently |

3. What do the two choices concern?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A How Luca finishes before the transition | B Whether the room ever moves to story time |
| C A new permanent center rule | D Unlimited building time |

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

transition

Move from one activity, place, or part of the day to another.

IN USE support a transition

advance warning

Notice given before an expected change.

IN USE give advance warning

transition cue

Signal indicating an approaching or current change of activity.

IN USE use a transition cue

visual schedule

Sequence of activities represented through pictures or other visual supports.

IN USE refer to the visual schedule

first-then language

Wording that makes a short sequence of actions explicit.

IN USE use first-then language

bounded choice

Choice among genuinely available options within a clear limit.

IN USE offer a bounded choice

predictable routine

Repeated sequence that helps people anticipate what comes next.

IN USE maintain a predictable routine

finishing point

Defined place at which an activity pauses or ends.

IN USE identify a finishing point

last step

Final action before moving to the next part of a routine.

IN USE name the last step

preserved work

Work kept rather than dismantled or discarded immediately.

IN USE protect preserved work

marked shelf

Clearly identified storage or display location.

IN USE use the marked shelf

photography permission

Applicable consent and authority for taking or using images.

IN USE verify photography permission

Precision check

You can choose the last block or a permitted photograph offers two available ways to finish. Do you want story time? suggests that declining the transition is allowed. Match the grammar of the choice to the actual options.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

approved device

Equipment permitted under the organization's actual arrangements.

IN USE use an approved device

image storage

Process and location for keeping photographs or other images.

IN USE follow image-storage rules

return expectation

Belief about when a person can resume an activity.

IN USE clarify the return expectation

cleanup routine

Agreed process for putting away or arranging materials.

IN USE follow the cleanup routine

group movement

Coordinated move of children between places or activities.

IN USE support group movement

supervision continuity

Maintaining appropriate adult oversight throughout a change.

IN USE preserve supervision continuity

processing time

Time needed to understand and respond to information.

IN USE allow processing time

follow-through

Carrying out an agreed action or stated boundary.

IN USE provide calm follow-through

negotiable detail

Aspect of a plan that can genuinely be chosen or changed.

IN USE identify the negotiable detail

nonnegotiable boundary

Limit that is not offered as a choice in the current arrangement.

IN USE state the nonnegotiable boundary

rushed instruction

Direction given too quickly or late for an effective response.

IN USE avoid a rushed instruction

consistent cue

Signal used in an aligned way across adults or occasions.

IN USE agree on a consistent cue

Precision check

Preserving the structure does not establish when Luca will return to it. A photograph also requires the actual permission, device, storage, and privacy arrangements. Do not treat a useful transition idea as authorization to use a personal phone.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

GIVE ADVANCE NOTICE

"Story time begins in five minutes."

NAME THE BOUNDARY

"We will move to story time after this finishing step."

OFFER THE TWO CHOICES

"You can add the last block, or I can take a photo using our center's camera."

SHOW THE STORAGE PLACE

"Your structure can stay on the marked shelf."

KEEP THE CHOICE GENUINE

"Both options are available under our current arrangement."

AVOID AN OPEN-ENDED PROMISE

"I cannot promise unlimited building time."

USE A SHORT SEQUENCE

"First we finish this step; then we move to story time."

PRESERVE THE WORK

"We do not need to dismantle the structure for this transition."

In five minutes

Provides a concrete warning tied to the supplied routine.

Last block or photograph

Gives a limited, real choice rather than an indefinite negotiation.

First, then

Makes the action sequence understandable.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

CLARIFY THE PHOTO CONDITION

"Any photograph must follow the center's permitted practice."

ALLOW A RESPONSE

"I will give Luca time to understand the two choices."

DO NOT MAKE THE CHILD CHOOSE SAFETY

"Supervision remains our responsibility."

FOLLOW THROUGH CALMLY

"The finishing choice does not change the move to story time."

AVOID A FALSE RETURN TIME

"We have not agreed on when the building will resume."

KEEP ADULT CUES ALIGNED

"Let us use the same transition message."

RESPECT THE EFFORT

"You have been working on this structure."

CLOSE THE SEQUENCE

"The work stays on the marked shelf, and the group moves to the story."

Can stay

Refers to the current permission without promising permanent preservation.

Any photograph must

Keeps a useful option inside actual privacy arrangements.

Does not change

Maintains the boundary without withdrawing the finishing choices.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

03

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which child-facing message matches the arrangement?

- A** Story time is in five minutes; choose the last block or a permitted photograph before we move.
- B** Do you want to go to story time at all?
- C** Build for as long as you like.
- D** I guarantee you can return at a specific time not provided here.

2. Which statement about the structure is supported?

- A** It can block any walkway.
- B** It can remain on the marked shelf under the current arrangement.
- C** It must be destroyed immediately.
- D** It will remain forever.

3. Which photography action is inappropriate?

- A** Follow the center's permitted practice.
- B** Check the applicable arrangements.
- C** Keep the option conditional on permission.
- D** Use an unapproved personal phone because the picture would help.

4. What should remain with the adults?

- A** Permission to abandon the routine without explanation
- B** Responsibility for supervision during the transition
- C** A child's duty to supervise the group alone
- D** A promise that every child will feel the same

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

Five minutes to story time

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

bounded choice / first-then language / advance warning / photography permission / processing time / preserved work / consistent cue / nonnegotiable boundary / Supervision continuity / return expectation

- 01 **Ben:** Luca is still building, and story time starts in five minutes. I want to help him finish without telling him the whole structure has to come down.
- 02 **Nora:** Start with ¹ _____: "Story time begins in five minutes." Then explain that the current arrangement allows his structure to stay on the marked shelf.
- 03 **Ben:** That could help. He has put effort into it, so moving on does not need to sound as though the work is being thrown away.
- 04 **Nora:** Exactly. Name the ² _____ and show where it will stay. We can respect the effort while keeping the transition clear.
- 05 **Ben:** I can say, "You can add the last block, or I can take a photo using our center's camera." I will check our photo arrangements first.
- 06 **Nora:** That is a ³ _____. Both options concern how to finish. Neither means the group waits indefinitely or that story time becomes optional.
- 07 **Ben:** I should avoid saying, "Do you want to go to story time?" if I am not actually offering the possibility of staying here instead.
- 08 **Nora:** Right. State the ⁴ _____ calmly, then offer the finishing choices. The question should not imply an option that disappears as soon as he chooses it.
- 09 **Ben:** I could say, "First the last step, then story time." That gives him a short sequence rather than several instructions in one breath.
- 10 **Nora:** Use that ⁵ _____ with the actual options. It helps us keep the sequence clear without promising extra building time beyond the arrangement.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Ben:** The photo option needs a clear handoff between us. I do not want someone taking out a personal phone while we are moving the children.
- 12 **Nora:** The option still requires ⁶ _____ and the permitted device and storage practice. We should not treat the child-facing choice as permission to bypass those arrangements.
- 13 **Ben:** I will also avoid promising that Luca can return immediately after the story. We have permission to preserve the structure, not a supplied return slot.
- 14 **Nora:** Correct. Keep the ⁷ _____ accurate. We can explain what stays without inventing when the next building opportunity will happen.
- 15 **Ben:** If he is still looking at the tower, I will pause and keep the choices the same. Repeating them faster is not helping him finish.
- 16 **Nora:** Allow ⁸ _____. The wording can stay short and consistent, with the same boundary instead of a new offer every few seconds.
- 17 **Ben:** During the move, we still need to keep the group appropriately supervised. Offering Luca a choice does not make him responsible for everyone else.
- 18 **Nora:** Yes. ⁹ _____ stays with us. Coordinate the adults and materials through our actual routine, not through an assumption that the children will manage it.
- 19 **Ben:** Then the message is five minutes, one of the two finishing choices, structure on the marked shelf, and a clear move to story time.
- 20 **Nora:** That gives us a ¹⁰ _____. We can acknowledge his work, follow through calmly, and keep the choice meaningful without changing the agreed boundary.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. advance warning | 2. preserved work | 3. bounded choice | 4. nonnegotiable boundary | 5. first-then language | 6. photography permission | 7. return expectation | 8. processing time | 9. Supervision continuity | 10. consistent cue

Offer a different finishing choice

F Say it

Drawing time ends in three minutes. The current arrangement allows the drawing to stay in the named tray. Ari can add one final line or ask the educator to label the work. The next activity is music.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

label / line / tray / three

Educator: "Music begins in ¹ _____ minutes."

Ari: "My drawing can stay in the named ² _____."

Educator: "You can add one final ³ _____."

Ari: "Or I can ask you to ⁴ _____ the work."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. three | 2. tray | 3. line | 4. label

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Nora and Ben's checked exchange. Stress five minutes, last block or photo, and the marked shelf.
2. Switch roles. Repeat the first-then sentence with a calm boundary and the two printed choices; do not invent a return time.
3. Complete the drawing-to-music transfer, check the key, then read it with the three-minute warning and named tray unchanged.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

One large scoop

A Read the situation

04

Describe a peer disagreement neutrally and model a concrete turn-taking sequence without assigning an unobserved motive.

Two children reach for the same large scoop. Educator Sora saw Ari holding it and then Bea reaching toward it; Sora does not know either child motive. Ari wants to finish one container. Bea wants the large scoop next. A smaller scoop is available. Sora and colleague Leon discuss language for supporting the disagreement. No injury or ongoing danger is stated. Staff must remain responsive to actual safety needs, preserve both requests, and avoid describing either child as selfish, manipulative, or deliberately aggressive based on this observation.

PEOPLE / Sora: Educator who observed the interaction | Leon: Colleague supporting the play area

VALIDATE A WISH WITHOUT ENDORSING EVERY ACTION

A child can want an object without being entitled to take it immediately. Name the wish, describe the current use, and support a practical next step. Neutral language is not passive: adults can maintain safety and a clear boundary without claiming to know motives.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What did Sora directly observe?

- A** Ari holding the large scoop, then Bea reaching toward it
- C** An injury requiring a supplied treatment

- B** Bea deliberately trying to upset Ari
- D** A completed agreement between both children

2. What does Ari want to finish?

- A** A timed ten-minute task supplied in the case
- C** Every container indefinitely

- B** One container
- D** The whole session alone

3. Which additional resource is available?

- A** A new toy outside the room
- C** A second large scoop

- B** A smaller scoop
- D** An invented timer agreement

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

co-regulation

Supportive interaction in which an adult helps a child manage responses and build regulation skills.

IN USE provide co-regulation

self-regulation

Developing ability to manage attention, feelings, and actions toward a goal.

IN USE support self-regulation

emotional validation

Acknowledgment of a person's feeling or wish without approving every action.

IN USE offer emotional validation

neutral description

Account of observable events without adding blame or guessed motive.

IN USE use a neutral description

observed sequence

Order of events actually seen or recorded.

IN USE preserve the observed sequence

inferred motive

Assumed reason for an action rather than a directly established fact.

IN USE avoid an inferred motive

turn-taking

Sharing access through an understandable sequence of use.

IN USE support turn-taking

current use

What a person is doing with an item at the relevant moment.

IN USE acknowledge current use

waiting option

Available activity or resource during a wait.

IN USE offer a waiting option

alternative resource

Different available item that may meet some of the same needs.

IN USE offer an alternative resource

finishing point

Defined end of a current action before a next step.

IN USE agree a finishing point

next turn

Opportunity to use something after the current user finishes the agreed step.

IN USE clarify the next turn

Precision check

I saw Ari holding the scoop, then Bea reaching describes a sequence. Bea wanted to upset Ari assigns a motive that is not established. Keep observations and interpretations separate while responding appropriately to any actual safety concern.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

resource conflict

Disagreement involving access to an object, space, or material.

IN USE mediate a resource conflict

peer interaction

Exchange or activity involving children with one another.

IN USE observe peer interaction

calm boundary

Clear limit expressed without shaming or escalating the exchange.

IN USE state a calm boundary

emotion vocabulary

Words that help describe feelings and their intensity.

IN USE model emotion vocabulary

impulse

Immediate urge to act before reflection or regulation.

IN USE support impulse management

adult modeling

Showing a response or language pattern through the adult's own behavior.

IN USE use adult modeling

repair

Action that helps address a disruption or harm in a relationship or activity.

IN USE support an appropriate repair

forced apology

Required apology words without necessarily establishing understanding or repair.

IN USE distinguish repair from a forced apology

reciprocity

Mutual responsiveness in an interaction.

IN USE encourage reciprocity

perspective-taking

Recognizing that another person may have a different view or intention.

IN USE support perspective-taking

conflict resolution

Process of addressing a disagreement and its practical next steps.

IN USE support conflict resolution

agreement check

Confirmation that the proposed arrangement has been understood or accepted.

IN USE make an agreement check

Precision check

The smaller scoop is a different resource, not a second copy of the large one. Offer it honestly as a waiting option. A proposed next turn is not a completed agreement until the children have been supported to understand the arrangement.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

DESCRIBE WHAT WAS SEEN

"I saw Ari holding the large scoop and Bea reaching toward it."

ACKNOWLEDGE BOTH WISHES

"Both children want to use the large scoop."

NAME THE FINISHING POINT

"Ari wants to finish one container."

OFFER THE ACTUAL ALTERNATIVE

"The smaller scoop is available while waiting."

AVOID A MOTIVE CLAIM

"I do not know why Bea reached at that moment."

NAME CURRENT USE

"Ari is using the large scoop now."

PRESERVE THE NEXT REQUEST

"Bea wants the large scoop next."

DO NOT PRETEND EQUIVALENCE

"The smaller scoop is an option, not an identical replacement."

I saw

Marks firsthand observation rather than interpretation.

At that moment

Avoids turning a single action into a fixed character trait.

Now and next

Makes the resource sequence concrete.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

MODEL A SHORT SEQUENCE

"First Ari finishes this container; then it is Bea's turn."

VALIDATE WITHOUT SURRENDERING

"You want the big scoop. Ari is using it now; you can have the next turn."

KEEP ADULT SUPPORT PRESENT

"I will stay responsive to the interaction."

SEPARATE WORDS AND REPAIR

"An apology alone does not settle access to the scoop."

KEEP LANGUAGE NEUTRAL

"Let us describe the action without labeling either child."

CHECK THE PROPOSAL

"We need to help both children understand the next step."

AVOID AN INVENTED TIME

"No exact number of waiting minutes has been agreed."

CLOSE PRACTICALLY

"Name the current turn, the finishing point, and the next turn clearly."

An option, not identical

Preserves the real difference between available resources.

Help both understand

Treats a proposed arrangement as something to support, not an automatic result.

Stay responsive

Keeps adult attention present rather than assuming the conflict is solved by one sentence.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which account avoids an unsupported motive?

- A** Both children planned to disrupt the session.
- B** Ari held the large scoop; Bea then reached toward it.
- C** Bea deliberately wanted to upset Ari.
- D** Ari is always selfish.

2. Which proposal uses the supplied facts?

- A** Ari finishes one container, then Bea has the next supported turn; the smaller scoop is available meanwhile.
- B** Bea must wait exactly ten minutes.
- C** Ari keeps the scoop for the entire session.
- D** A second large scoop is available.

3. What does emotional validation mean here?

- A** Allow any action because the wish is strong.
- B** Deny that either child has a preference.
- C** Diagnose the cause of every feeling.
- D** Acknowledge wanting the scoop without approving every action used to obtain it.

4. What remains necessary after proposing the sequence?

- A** Record a guaranteed permanent resolution.
- B** Support understanding and remain responsive to the actual interaction.
- C** Assume every child agreed without checking.
- D** Leave all supervision to the children.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

One large scoop

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

alternative resource / emotional validation / observed sequence / inferred motive / co-regulation / turn-taking / neutral description / finishing point / next turn / agreement check

- 01 **Leon:** Sora, what happened with the large scoop? I heard a disagreement, but I did not see how it began and do not want to repeat the wrong story.
- 02 **Sora:** The ¹ _____ was Ari holding it, then Bea reaching toward it. I do not know the motive, and I should keep that uncertainty clear.
- 03 **Leon:** Then describing Bea as deliberately upsetting Ari would add something we did not establish. We can describe the reach without attaching that explanation.
- 04 **Sora:** Yes. That would be an ² _____. It can affect how colleagues treat the child later, so the record and conversation should not present it as fact.
- 05 **Leon:** What are they asking for now? If Ari has nearly finished something, we may be able to make the next turn clearer than just saying share.
- 06 **Sora:** Ari wants to finish one container. Bea wants the large scoop next. That gives us a possible ³ _____ and a next-turn request to work with.
- 07 **Leon:** We could say, "Ari is using the large scoop now. Bea wants it next." That names the situation without saying one child is bad for wanting it.
- 08 **Sora:** That is a ⁴ _____. It helps us respond to the actual resource issue while staying attentive to any safety concern.
- 09 **Leon:** I can offer the smaller scoop while Bea waits. I will say it is smaller; telling Bea it is just the same would ignore what she wants.
- 10 **Sora:** Exactly. It is an ⁵ _____, not an identical replacement. We can name what is available without denying that Bea specifically wants the larger one.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Leon:** How do we acknowledge the wish without suggesting that reaching for whatever you want always gets you immediate access?
- 12 **Sora:** Use ⁶ _____ alongside the boundary: "You want the scoop. Ari is finishing this container, and we can help with your turn next."
- 13 **Leon:** That is more useful than simply saying share over and over. It describes what happens now, what ends the current use, and what comes afterward.
- 14 **Sora:** A concrete ⁷ _____ sequence can help. We still need to support both children in understanding it rather than assume one sentence settles everything.
- 15 **Leon:** We should not add a ten-minute wait or an exact timer rule, because neither is part of the arrangement we have described.
- 16 **Sora:** Correct. The ⁸ _____ is linked to finishing that container. Keep the wording aligned with the actual proposal instead of introducing another condition halfway through.
- 17 **Leon:** And if one child remains upset, we stay responsive. A calm adult presence and clear language matter more than demanding the right apology words immediately.
- 18 **Sora:** That is part of ⁹ _____. We can model calm language and maintain the boundary without treating a forced phrase as proof that the practical conflict is resolved.
- 19 **Leon:** Then we describe the sequence, preserve both requests, offer the smaller scoop honestly, and help the children understand the proposed current and next turns.
- 20 **Sora:** Yes, with an ¹⁰ _____ and continued attention. We have a supported proposal, not evidence that the children have already agreed or that no further help will be needed.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. observed sequence | 2. inferred motive | 3. finishing point | 4. neutral description | 5. alternative resource | 6. emotional validation | 7. turn-taking | 8. next turn | 9. co-regulation | 10. agreement check

Describe another resource disagreement

F Say it

Noor is using the red truck and wants to finish one route. Eli wants it next. A blue truck is available. The educator observed Eli reaching but does not know the motive.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

blue / red / unknown / route

Educator: "Noor is using the ¹ _____ truck."

Colleague: "The finishing point is one ² _____."

Educator: "A ³ _____ truck is available meanwhile."

Colleague: "The motive for reaching is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. red | 2. route | 3. blue | 4. unknown

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Sora and Leon's corrected dialogue. Keep what was seen separate from the motive that was not established.
2. Switch roles. Repeat the child-facing now-and-next lines with one container as the finishing point and the smaller scoop as the alternative.
3. Complete the red-truck/blue-truck transfer, check the key, then read it without inventing a motive or a waiting time.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Celebrate the observation

A Read the situation

Share a specific learning observation warmly while rejecting unsupported developmental rankings and diagnoses.

05

During a supervised activity today, educator Rosa saw Eli sort four buttons by color and heard Eli say, "These go together." Parent Andre asks whether this proves Eli is ahead of every child of the same age. No comparison data, developmental screening, or broader assessment is supplied. Rosa can describe the action, exact words, context, and date of observation, but cannot turn them into a universal ranking. The button activity is fictional and requires appropriate materials, age suitability, and supervision; it is not a recommendation to give small loose items to every child.

PEOPLE / Andre: Eli's parent | Rosa: Early-years educator

WARMTH DOES NOT REQUIRE EXAGGERATION

A parent may hear a cautious answer as a refusal to celebrate. Start with the actual achievement and explain why it is worth sharing. Then distinguish the observation from a comparison that has not been made, without sounding as though the child work is unimportant.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What did Rosa observe?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A A diagnosis of exceptional ability | B Eli sorting four buttons by color during a supervised activity |
| C Eli outperforming every same-age child | D A completed developmental screening |

2. Which words belong inside quotation marks in Rosa's note?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A I can sort all the colors. | B These go together. |
| C These four buttons are the same color. | D I counted four matching buttons. |

3. What evidence is missing for the parent's claim?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A The fact that the activity was supervised | B Appropriate comparison data and broader assessment |
| C Any observation at all | D The educator's identity |

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

observation record

Account of what was noticed in a defined context.

IN USE create an observation record

anecdotal note

Brief factual account of a meaningful event or behavior.

IN USE write an anecdotal note

verbatim quotation

Exact words reproduced without changing their wording.

IN USE preserve a verbatim quotation

context

Circumstances in which an event or response occurred.

IN USE record the context

work sample

Example of a child's work used as one source of information.

IN USE collect a work sample

learning story

Narrative account connecting observed learning with its context and meaning.

IN USE develop a learning story

classification

Grouping items according to shared features.

IN USE observe classification

sorting criterion

Feature used to decide which items belong together.

IN USE identify the sorting criterion

attribute

Observable feature such as color, shape, or size.

IN USE name an attribute

one-to-one correspondence

Matching one item with one other item or one count word.

IN USE observe one-to-one correspondence

cardinality

Understanding that the final count word represents the number in a set.

IN USE explore cardinality

fine-motor skill

Coordinated use of small muscles, often in hand and finger activity.

IN USE observe fine-motor skills

Precision check

Sorting four objects by color does not establish counting to four, cardinality, or every other early mathematics skill. Name the feature actually observed. The number of objects in the activity is not automatically evidence that the child counted them.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

developmental domain

Area of development such as language, physical, or social development.

IN USE distinguish developmental domains

developmental milestone

Skill or behavior associated with development, interpreted with appropriate variation and context.

IN USE discuss a developmental milestone

formative assessment

Information used during learning to guide support and next steps.

IN USE use formative assessment

summative assessment

Assessment of achievement at a defined endpoint.

IN USE distinguish summative assessment

developmental screening

Structured process identifying whether further developmental evaluation may be needed.

IN USE distinguish developmental screening

diagnostic assessment

Qualified evaluation used to establish a diagnosis or detailed explanation.

IN USE refer for diagnostic assessment

comparison group

Relevant group used as a basis for interpreting comparative results.

IN USE identify the comparison group

norm-referenced measure

Assessment interpreted in relation to an appropriate reference population.

IN USE interpret a norm-referenced measure

criterion-referenced measure

Assessment interpreted against specified criteria rather than a peer ranking alone.

IN USE use a criterion-referenced measure

reliability

Consistency of a measurement or assessment under relevant conditions.

IN USE examine reliability

validity

Support for the intended interpretation and use of assessment information.

IN USE examine validity

strength-based description

Account that recognizes capabilities without exaggerating or ignoring support needs.

IN USE use a strength-based description

Precision check

Observation, screening, and diagnosis serve different purposes. A single successful moment can be worth sharing without establishing a stable ability across settings or a rank among peers. Use the actual evidence and appropriate assessment processes for broader conclusions.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

SHARE THE OBSERVATION

"Today I saw Eli sort four buttons by color."

NAME THE SETTING

"This happened during the supervised activity."

LIMIT THE COMPARISON

"This observation does not rank Eli against every child of the same age."

SEPARATE SKILLS

"Sorting by color does not by itself establish counting skill."

PRESERVE THE WORDS

"Eli said, "These go together.""

CELEBRATE SPECIFICALLY

"I wanted to share the way Eli grouped the colors."

DO NOT MINIMIZE

"The observation is useful even without a comparative claim."

IDENTIFY THE CRITERION

"Color was the feature used to group the buttons."

Today I saw

Identifies the observer and time rather than presenting a timeless trait.

Said

Introduces exact words when quoted accurately.

By color

Names the observed grouping feature.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A DIAGNOSIS

"This was not a developmental diagnosis."

DISTINGUISH SCREENING

"No developmental screening result is supplied here."

INVITE FACTUAL FAMILY INPUT

"We can record relevant examples you have observed at home."

KEEP SOURCES SEPARATE

"A home report and my observation should each retain their source."

AVOID A FIXED LABEL

"One moment does not define every aspect of Eli's development."

USE A PRECISE RECORD

"Include the action, words, context, and observation date."

EXPLAIN A BROADER CLAIM

"A wider conclusion needs appropriate additional evidence."

CLOSE WARMLY

"We can celebrate this moment and keep the description accurate."

Does not rank

Rejects the unsupported comparison without denying the observation.

By itself

Leaves room for broader evidence without pretending it is already present.

Celebrate and accurate

Shows that warmth and evidence limits can coexist.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which message is both warm and accurate?

- A** Eli grouped four buttons by color and said, "These go together"; I wanted to share that moment.
- B** Eli is definitely ahead of every peer.
- C** The observation means nothing because it is not a test.
- D** Eli has mastered all mathematics.

2. Which skill is not established just by the described sorting?

- A** Participating in the supervised activity
- B** Counting the four objects accurately
- C** Grouping by color in this activity
- D** Using the quoted words

3. What would a precise note include?

- A** A peer rank invented from one event
- B** Action, exact words where quoted, context, and observation date
- C** Only a label such as genius
- D** A diagnosis with no evaluation

4. How should a home example be handled?

- A** Record it as something Rosa personally saw.
- B** Treat it as proof of every developmental domain.
- C** Delete the original activity note.
- D** Keep it attributed to the family and distinct from Rosa's observation.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

Celebrate the observation

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

sorting criterion / observation record / anecdotal note / strength-based description /
Developmental screening / verbatim quotation / developmental domains / Classification / context
/ comparison group

- 01 **Andre:** Rosa, you mentioned that Eli sorted buttons today. Does that mean he is ahead of every other child his age? He seems very quick with things at home.
- 02 **Rosa:** I can share a specific ¹ _____. Today I saw Eli sort four buttons by color during a supervised activity, and I heard, "These go together."
- 03 **Andre:** I am pleased to hear that. I do not want a technical report, but I would like to understand exactly what made you notice the moment.
- 04 **Rosa:** The ² _____ was color. Eli grouped the items on that basis, and the words connected with the action. That is the specific moment I wanted to share.
- 05 **Andre:** He will be pleased you noticed. When I ask how his day went, I usually get one word. This gives me something specific to talk about with him.
- 06 **Rosa:** Exactly. A ³ _____ can celebrate what happened without adding a ranking. I do not need to overstate it to say it was worth noticing.
- 07 **Andre:** Four buttons sounds like counting practice too. Did he actually count them aloud, or was he just putting matching colors together?
- 08 **Rosa:** They are separate. ⁴ _____ by color does not prove he counted them. Four objects were present, but we should not add an unobserved counting action to the note.
- 09 **Andre:** I have also heard people mention a developmental check. Is this note part of a screening, or are you sharing something you noticed during play?
- 10 **Rosa:** ⁵ _____ has a different purpose and process. This conversation does not supply a screening result, and the observation is not a diagnosis.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Andre:** I see. His cousin did something similar later, so I started comparing them. That is probably not enough to say where Eli stands with children his age.
- 12 **Rosa:** Yes. A relevant ⁶ _____ and appropriate assessment evidence would matter. A single classroom moment does not establish that Eli is ahead of every same-age child.
- 13 **Andre:** Did he really say, "These go together"? I would like to remember his own words. That sounds just like something he would say at home.
- 14 **Rosa:** I will preserve the ⁷ _____ when quoting him. If I paraphrase elsewhere, I should make that clear rather than put new words into his mouth.
- 15 **Andre:** At home I have seen him put similar objects together too. Is that useful to tell you, even if it is not a formal assessment?
- 16 **Rosa:** Yes, with the ⁸ _____ and source kept clear. Your home example and my observation can both inform a conversation without being recorded as the same event.
- 17 **Andre:** At home he sometimes loses interest halfway through. Does that mean today's success does not count, or can you see different things on different days?
- 18 **Rosa:** Different ⁹ _____ and settings can show different patterns. We should not turn this one observation into a fixed description of all his abilities.
- 19 **Andre:** That makes sense. I can enjoy hearing what he did without needing it to prove a rank. Please keep sharing these specific moments with me.
- 20 **Rosa:** I will. A useful ¹⁰ _____ includes what happened, what was said, and when and where it occurred. We can be enthusiastic and precise at the same time.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. observation record | 2. sorting criterion | 3. strength-based description | 4. Classification | 5. Developmental screening | 6. comparison group | 7. verbatim quotation | 8. context | 9. developmental domains | 10. anecdotal note

Describe a shape-sorting observation

F Say it

Educator Noor observed Ari sort three large shapes by shape during a supervised activity today. Ari said, "These are the same." No counting action or peer comparison is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

comparison / same / three / shape

Noor: "The grouping feature was ¹ _____."

Parent: "There were ² _____ large shapes."

Noor: "Ari said, These are the ³ _____."

Parent: "No peer ⁴ _____ is established."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. shape | 2. three | 3. same | 4. comparison

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Andre and Rosa's checked exchange. Say Eli's exact quotation naturally, without adding counting or a peer rank.
2. Switch roles. Repeat the explanation distinguishing sorting, counting, and screening while keeping the parent conversation warm.
3. Complete the shape-sorting transfer, check the key, then read three objects as an activity fact, not proof of counting.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Pointing is a response

A Read the situation

Explain an allowed participation choice while distinguishing access, engagement, and evidence of spoken language.

A small-group story activity allows picture choices or spoken answers under Noor's current inclusion plan. Noor prefers pointing today. Colleague Ben describes that as nonparticipation. Educator Amina must explain that pointing is an allowed response without claiming it supplies the same evidence as a spoken sentence. No reason for Noor's preference, diagnosis, or home-language profile is supplied. The team can use inclusive language, record the actual response format, and keep future support connected to the plan rather than requiring speech as an unannounced condition of belonging.

PEOPLE / Amina: Early-years educator | Ben: Colleague observing the group

06

PARTICIPATION IS BROADER THAN ONE RESPONSE FORMAT

A quiet response may be easy to overlook in a busy group. Identify what the child actually did and whether it fits the activity plan. Respect a permitted communication choice without pretending that pointing and speaking demonstrate exactly the same language skills.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which response formats does the plan allow?

- A Picture choices or spoken answers
- C No response of any kind

- B Spoken sentences only
- D Only copying another child

2. What does Noor prefer today?

- A Leaving the group as an established fact
- C A supplied spoken presentation

- B Pointing
- D A new diagnosis

3. What should the team avoid claiming?

- A That pointing is allowed here
- C That the plan should guide participation

- B That the actual response format matters
- D That pointing supplies identical evidence to a spoken sentence

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

inclusion plan

Agreed support arrangements for meaningful access and participation.

IN USE follow the inclusion plan

participation

Taking part in an activity through an appropriate available form.

IN USE recognize participation

engagement

Attention or involvement in an activity, described through relevant evidence.

IN USE observe engagement

response mode

Way a person answers or communicates in an activity.

IN USE record the response mode

picture choice

Selection among images used to express a response.

IN USE offer picture choices

pointing response

Indication made by pointing rather than speaking.

IN USE acknowledge a pointing response

spoken response

Answer communicated through speech.

IN USE record a spoken response

expressive language

Language used to convey meaning to others.

IN USE support expressive language

receptive language

Understanding of language received through listening, reading, or other input.

IN USE distinguish receptive language

communication access

Opportunity and support needed to receive and convey meaning.

IN USE provide communication access

visual support

Image or visual arrangement that helps understanding or expression.

IN USE use visual supports

gesture

Movement used to communicate meaning.

IN USE notice a gesture

Precision check

A permitted pointing response can be participation without being a spoken sentence. Record what Noor selected and how the response was made. Do not convert pointing into either no participation or evidence of a spoken-language performance that did not occur.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

augmentative communication

Methods that support existing speech or communication.

IN USE use appropriate augmentative communication

alternative communication

Methods used instead of speech for some or all communication.

IN USE support alternative communication

AAC

Augmentative and alternative communication: tools and strategies supporting communication.

IN USE follow the AAC plan

home language

Language used in the child's home or family life.

IN USE value the home language

dual language learner

Child learning two or more languages, including English alongside a home language.

IN USE support a dual language learner

language difference

Variation connected with languages used, distinct from an assumed disorder.

IN USE distinguish a language difference

language delay

Language skills developing more slowly than expected, assessed in context rather than inferred from one response or multilingualism.

IN USE refer a language-delay concern

multilingual repertoire

Languages and communication resources a person can draw on.

IN USE recognize a multilingual repertoire

family language information

Details families share about language use and communication.

IN USE gather family language information

access barrier

Feature that prevents or limits meaningful participation.

IN USE identify an access barrier

equitable opportunity

Fair access that may require different supports rather than identical treatment.

IN USE provide equitable opportunity

evidence limit

Boundary on what an observation supports.

IN USE state the evidence limit

Precision check

Noor choosing to point today does not establish a diagnosis, reluctance, home language, or general language ability. Home-language information should come from appropriate sources and family partnership, not inference from a name or a single classroom response.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

REFER TO THE PLAN

"Noor's current plan allows picture choices or spoken answers."

RECOGNIZE PARTICIPATION

"Pointing is an allowed response in this activity."

KEEP EVIDENCE PRECISE

"No spoken sentence was recorded in that response."

SEPARATE THE AIMS

"Access to the story and evidence of spoken language are related but distinct."

NAME TODAY'S CHOICE

"Noor prefers pointing today."

STATE THE OBSERVATION

"Noor selected a picture by pointing."

AVOID AN ALL-OR-NOTHING LABEL

"A nonspeaking response is not automatically nonparticipation."

REJECT A GUESSED DIAGNOSIS

"This response alone does not establish a language delay."

06

Current plan

Anchors the response choice to the actual arrangement.

Today

Limits the statement to the observed preference rather than a permanent trait.

Allowed response

Connects the action to participation criteria.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A LANGUAGE ASSUMPTION

"We do not know Noor's home-language profile from this observation."

USE THE AVAILABLE OPTIONS

"We can make both permitted response formats accessible."

VALUE FAMILY INFORMATION

"Family language information should retain its source and context."

NAME THE BARRIER

"Requiring speech without changing the plan would remove an allowed route."

KEEP SUPPORT PLANNED

"Any change in support should follow the appropriate planning process."

RESPECT TODAY'S PREFERENCE

"We should not remove the allowed choice because speech is more noticeable."

AVOID FALSE EQUIVALENCE

"The two response modes do not provide identical evidence."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"Noor participated by pointing; that is the response we should record."

No spoken sentence

States the evidence limit without denying engagement.

Related but distinct

Prevents access and assessment from being treated as the same question.

From this observation

Blocks unsupported conclusions about language background or diagnosis.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which note is most accurate?

- A** Noor has a confirmed language delay.
- B** Noor participated by selecting a picture through pointing; no spoken sentence was recorded.
- C** Noor did not participate because there was no speech.
- D** Noor produced a complete spoken sentence.

2. Which action conflicts with the current plan?

- A** Record whether the response was spoken.
- B** Require spoken answers as the only way to count participation.
- C** Offer picture choices.
- D** Accept a pointing response.

3. What can be inferred about the home language?

- A** It must be English
- B** It must be a particular language based on the name Noor
- C** There is no language used at home
- D** Nothing specific from the supplied pointing preference alone

4. Which distinction matters?

- A** Inclusion means never documenting response differences.
- B** Participation can be valid while evidence of spoken-language production remains limited.
- C** Every response mode proves identical language skills.
- D** Pointing always proves noncomprehension.

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

Pointing is a response

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

response mode / inclusion plan / evidence limit / language difference / participation / expressive language / visual support / Family language information / access barrier / equitable opportunity

06

- 01 **Ben:** Noor did not give a spoken answer in the story group. I was going to mark that as not participating, but you seem to have recorded a response.
- 02 **Amina:** The ¹ _____ allows picture choices or spoken answers. Noor preferred pointing today and selected a picture, which is an allowed response in this activity.
- 03 **Ben:** I saw the pointing, but I was listening for a sentence. I may have treated the response I expected as the only response that counted.
- 04 **Amina:** That confuses ² _____ with one particular format. We should recognize the actual response while staying precise about what it demonstrates.
- 05 **Ben:** Does that mean we should describe pointing as exactly the same evidence as a spoken answer? I do not want our notes to lose the difference.
- 06 **Amina:** No. The ³ _____ matters. We can write that Noor selected a picture by pointing and that no spoken sentence was recorded in that response.
- 07 **Ben:** I will change my note from no response to selected a picture by pointing. That is what I saw; I did not hear a sentence.
- 08 **Amina:** Exactly. The ⁴ _____ stays visible. A meaningful contribution does not need to be exaggerated into evidence of a different kind of performance.
- 09 **Ben:** Could the preference mean a language delay, or tell us which language Noor uses at home? I have heard colleagues make those assumptions.
- 10 **Amina:** Neither follows from this moment. A ⁵ _____ or concern needs appropriate information, not an inference from one pointing response or from the child's name.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Ben:** So we should not record a particular home language unless we actually have that information through the proper family and record process.
- 12 **Amina:** Correct. ⁶ _____ should be gathered respectfully and attributed accurately. We should not create a language profile to explain an observation we have not investigated.
- 13 **Ben:** If I insist on a spoken sentence before Noor can count as taking part, I would be removing one of the routes the plan currently allows.
- 14 **Amina:** That would create an ⁷ _____. We can support the activity through its available options rather than change the participation rule without the appropriate process.
- 15 **Ben:** We still need to notice how children use language over time. Recognizing pointing should not mean we stop describing the language we actually hear.
- 16 **Amina:** Agreed. Evidence of ⁸ _____ should identify the actual form and context. Precise observation and inclusive participation are compatible, not opposing goals.
- 17 **Ben:** Before the next group, let us put the picture choices where Noor can reach them. They are not much help if they stay behind my chair.
- 18 **Amina:** Yes. The ⁹ _____ needs to be accessible through the planned arrangement. We should check the environment rather than interpret a missing opportunity as a child failure.
- 19 **Ben:** I will change my note to describe the pointing response and its limits. I will not label it nonparticipation or infer a diagnosis or home language.
- 20 **Amina:** That supports ¹⁰ _____. Noor used an allowed option today, and we can keep both the participation and the response difference clear.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. inclusion plan | 2. participation | 3. response mode | 4. evidence limit | 5. language difference | 6. Family language information | 7. access barrier | 8. expressive language | 9. visual support | 10. equitable opportunity

Record another permitted response mode

F Say it

Ari's current story plan permits a spoken answer or a picture selection. Ari selects a picture today. No spoken answer or home-language information is supplied.

06

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unspecified / plan / recorded / picture

Educator: "The selected response used a ¹ _____."

Colleague: "A spoken answer was not ² _____."

Educator: "The choice was allowed by the current ³ _____."

Colleague: "The home-language profile remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. picture | 2. recorded | 3. plan | 4. unspecified

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Amina and Ben's corrected dialogue. Contrast selected a picture with no spoken sentence, without calling the child unresponsive.
2. Switch roles. Repeat the exchange about making the picture choices physically accessible under the current plan.
3. Complete Ari's transfer, check the key, then read the permitted response and unspecified home language as separate facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A reported allergy-plan change

A Read the situation

Receive a parent health-plan update and make an accountable document handoff without inventing a care decision.

Theo's parent, Morgan, tells educator Rosa that the allergy plan may have changed. The center still holds the earlier plan, and no revised document is available in this conversation. Health coordinator Amira is present and accepts the document query. No food decision, exposure, symptoms, or emergency is part of this case. Rosa must take the report seriously, preserve the difference between a reported change and a verified revision, and connect Morgan with Amira promptly. The exercise does not authorize changing treatment, relaxing controls, or ignoring a reported safety concern.

PEOPLE / Morgan: Theo's parent | Rosa: Early-years educator

07

TAKE AN UPDATE SERIOUSLY WITHOUT GUESSING ITS CONTENT

A missing revised document does not make a parent report unimportant. Acknowledge the concern and give it a receiving owner. At the same time, do not invent the revision, alter a treatment instruction, or announce that every relevant staff member has been updated before that happens.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does Morgan report?

- A** A food exposure occurred in this case.
- B** An emergency treatment decision is supplied.
- C** The allergy plan may have changed.
- D** A verified revision has already reached every staff member.

2. Which status is established when Amira accepts the document query?

- A** The revised allergy instructions are confirmed.
- B** The earlier plan has been formally superseded.
- C** Every educator has received the updated instructions.
- D** The question has a named receiving owner.

3. What remains unavailable?

- A** The parent's report
- B** The name of the receiving coordinator
- C** The revised document
- D** The fact that an earlier plan is held

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

allergy action plan

Individualized document specifying management of a known allergy under appropriate guidance.

IN USE verify the allergy action plan

healthcare plan

Agreed information and arrangements for a person's relevant health needs.

IN USE review the healthcare plan

reported change

Update described by a source but not necessarily verified.

IN USE record a reported change

verified revision

Updated version confirmed through the appropriate process.

IN USE obtain a verified revision

current version

Document version established as applicable for use.

IN USE confirm the current version

superseded version

Earlier document replaced through the appropriate process.

IN USE identify a superseded version

document control

Process for managing document versions, approval, access, and changes.

IN USE follow document control

health coordinator

Person responsible for coordinating specified health-information processes.

IN USE contact the health coordinator

parent report

Information attributed to a child's parent or carer.

IN USE preserve the parent report

source document

Original or authoritative record supporting an instruction or fact.

IN USE request the source document

care instruction

Direction governing an aspect of care from the appropriate source.

IN USE clarify a care instruction

emergency action plan

Defined arrangements for responding to an emergency.

IN USE follow the emergency action plan

Precision check

May have changed identifies a reported uncertainty. It is neither proof that the earlier plan remains suitable nor permission to invent a replacement. Escalate promptly through the real health process so the responsible people address the discrepancy and any immediate implications.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

allergen

Substance capable of triggering an allergic reaction in a susceptible person.

IN USE identify the relevant allergen

food intolerance

Adverse food response distinct from an immune-mediated food allergy.

IN USE distinguish food intolerance

allergic reaction

Immune response to an allergen that may require appropriate medical action.

IN USE recognize an allergic reaction

anaphylaxis

Serious allergic reaction requiring immediate emergency response.

IN USE follow anaphylaxis procedures

exposure

Contact with a substance or situation relevant to the concern.

IN USE record a reported exposure

cross-contact

Unintended transfer of an allergen from one food or surface to another.

IN USE prevent allergen cross-contact

medication authorization

Required permission or authority for medicine-related action under applicable rules.

IN USE verify medication authorization

training record

Documentation of completed relevant staff training.

IN USE check the training record

staff briefing

Sharing of relevant information with staff through an appropriate process.

IN USE document the staff briefing

incident record

Factual account of a relevant event, actions, and outcomes.

IN USE complete an incident record

handoff acknowledgment

Confirmation that the receiving person accepted the query or information.

IN USE obtain handoff acknowledgment

unresolved query

Question that still requires an appropriate answer or action.

IN USE track the unresolved query

Precision check

This case has no food decision, exposure, symptoms, or emergency. Do not create one in the record. In actual care, urgent or emergency action must follow the applicable plan and procedures without waiting for a routine document exchange.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE REPORT

"Thank you for telling me the plan may have changed."

NAME THE MISSING DOCUMENT

"The revised document is not available here."

NAME THE RECEIVING OWNER

"Amira has accepted the document query."

AVOID INVENTING THE REVISION

"I cannot state the new instructions without the appropriate verification."

STATE THE HELD RECORD

"We still hold the earlier plan."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"I will record this as a reported possible change."

MAKE THE NEXT STEP IMMEDIATE

"Let us connect you with Amira now."

DO NOT DISMISS THE REPORT

"The missing document does not mean we should ignore what you have told us."

07

May have changed

Retains the parent's uncertainty without dismissing the report.

Still hold

Describes the available document, not a judgment that it remains suitable.

Has accepted

Identifies a confirmed receiving person.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP DECISIONS SEPARATE

"This conversation does not establish a food or treatment decision."

CHECK ACTUAL RECEIPT

"Amira's acceptance gives the query an owner."

KEEP STAFF UPDATES FACTUAL

"Do not record a staff briefing before it has occurred."

KEEP EMERGENCY PRIORITIES

"Actual urgent concerns must follow the appropriate emergency or health route."

PROTECT SENSITIVE INFORMATION

"We should handle the health information through the appropriate private process."

AVOID FALSE COMPLETION

"The plan has not been confirmed as revised yet."

PRESERVE VERSION HISTORY

"The document process should show which version is applicable."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"Possible change reported, earlier plan held, revision unavailable, query accepted by Amira."

Now

Keeps a relevant safety-information query from drifting into an unspecified future task.

Not confirmed yet

Prevents a received question from being labeled a completed plan update.

Before it has occurred

Keeps documentation tied to actual communication events.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handoff is accurate?

- A** New instructions verified and every staff member trained.
- B** Theo had a reaction during this conversation.
- C** The report can be ignored until next month.
- D** Parent reports a possible plan change; earlier plan held; revision unavailable; Amira accepts the query.

2. What does Amira accepting the query establish?

- A** The document question has a receiving owner.
- B** The revised plan is verified.
- C** A new food decision is authorized.
- D** Every required staff briefing has occurred.

3. Which statement is unsafe as a general inference?

- A** The possible change needs appropriate follow-up.
- B** The exact revision is not supplied.
- C** Emergency procedures take precedence when applicable.
- D** No revised paper means the reported concern can be ignored.

4. What should not be added to the incident record for this case?

- A** An invented exposure, symptom, or treatment
- B** The attributed parent report
- C** The fact that Amira accepted the query
- D** The document discrepancy

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

A reported allergy-plan change

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

staff briefing / unresolved query / health coordinator / document control / allergy action plan / handoff acknowledgment / parent report / verified revision / incident record / reported change

07

- 01 **Morgan:** Rosa, I need to tell you that Theo's allergy plan may have changed. I do not have the revised document with me, but I do not want this overlooked.
- 02 **Rosa:** Thank you for telling me. I will record the ¹ _____ and connect you with health coordinator Amira, who is here and has accepted the document query.
- 03 **Morgan:** Does the fact that you still have the old document mean staff will simply assume nothing has changed? That is what I am concerned about.
- 04 **Rosa:** We need to address the ² _____ through our actual health process. Holding an earlier plan does not justify ignoring your report or guessing the new instructions.
- 05 **Morgan:** I need to check the new paperwork myself. Please do not take what I am saying as a complete set of replacement instructions.
- 06 **Rosa:** I will preserve that ³ _____ accurately. The record should not turn may have changed into a completed update or a treatment instruction you did not provide.
- 07 **Morgan:** Who will check which version should apply? I need to know this has reached someone responsible, rather than become a general note no one owns.
- 08 **Rosa:** Amira is the ⁴ _____ receiving the query. Let us connect you with her now so the discrepancy and its practical implications are handled through the appropriate process.
- 09 **Morgan:** I am calling about the paperwork, not to report a reaction today. I do not want anyone to think I have described an incident that did not happen.
- 10 **Rosa:** I will not add an ⁵ _____ that invents such an event. The information we have is your possible-plan-change report and the missing revised document.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Morgan:** I am worried another member of staff will see a note saying updated and assume you already have the new document. You do not have it yet.
- 12 **Rosa:** That is why ⁶ _____ matters. The earlier plan is held, the revised document is unavailable here, and the applicable version needs the appropriate confirmation.
- 13 **Morgan:** I can try to get the document through the approved route. Until then, I would rather the team ask Amira than piece together instructions from my memory.
- 14 **Rosa:** Agreed. A ⁷ _____ cannot be created by guessing. We must use the real source and authorization process, including any required communication to the people who need it.
- 15 **Morgan:** Once I speak with Amira, will she confirm what still needs doing? I do not want to leave believing the plan has been checked if it has not.
- 16 **Rosa:** No. The ⁸ _____ confirms ownership. It does not establish a completed verification, new care decision, or finished staff briefing.
- 17 **Morgan:** That distinction helps. Please keep the information private while making sure it reaches the appropriate staff through the actual process.
- 18 **Rosa:** Yes. Any ⁹ _____ must be appropriate and recorded accurately. We should not claim that everyone has received new instructions before that has happened.
- 19 **Morgan:** Then my report is taken seriously, but no one is pretending I supplied a complete new plan today. I will speak with Amira now.
- 20 **Rosa:** Correct. The ¹⁰ _____ question is with Amira. We will preserve the source, the missing revision, and the actual next actions without inventing a food or treatment decision.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. reported change | 2. unresolved query | 3. parent report | 4. health coordinator | 5. incident record | 6. document control | 7. verified revision | 8. handoff acknowledgment | 9. staff briefing | 10. allergy action plan

Hand off another health-document query

F Say it

Parent Ellis reports that a care plan may have changed. The earlier document is held, and the revised version is unavailable. Health coordinator Noor accepts the query. No symptoms are reported.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

symptoms / unavailable / Noor / held

Educator: "The revised document is ¹ _____."

Parent: "The earlier document is still ² _____."

Educator: "The receiving coordinator is ³ _____."

Parent: "No ⁴ _____ were reported in this conversation."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. unavailable | 2. held | 3. Noor | 4. symptoms

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Morgan and Rosa's checked exchange. Stress may have changed, earlier plan, revision unavailable, and Amira.
2. Switch roles. Repeat the immediate handoff without turning the parent report into new food or treatment instructions.
3. Complete the care-plan transfer, check the key, then read it without adding symptoms, verification, or a completed staff briefing.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A collection request to verify

A Read the situation

Verify a collection request respectfully, protect private information, and distinguish a stated relationship from confirmed authority.

An unfamiliar adult, Owen, tells educator Lea that he is Nia's uncle and has come instead of the usual collector. Today's collection authority has not been verified. Lead educator Rosa is available to check the arrangement, and Nia has not been released. Owen's statement does not establish his identity, family relationship, legal status, or authority for today. Lea needs to explain the verification step calmly, maintain the actual supervision arrangements, and avoid disclosing private contact details. The scenario does not supply a completed check or permission to release Nia.

PEOPLE / Owen: Adult requesting collection | Lea: Early-years educator

08

A CHECK IS NOT AN ACCUSATION

A calm explanation of the process can protect dignity without weakening the boundary. Unfamiliarity alone is not proof of wrongdoing, and a friendly relationship claim is not verified collection authority. Keep the child supervised and use the actual local checking and escalation arrangements.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does Owen state?

- A** He is Nia's uncle and has come to collect her.
- B** A verified court order names him.
- C** Rosa has approved the collection.
- D** He has already completed the required checks.

2. What is Nia's current status?

- A** She left with Owen.
- B** She is waiting unsupervised outside.
- C** She has authorized her own release.
- D** She has not been released.

3. Who is available to check the arrangement?

- A** An unidentified person tomorrow
- B** Nia acting alone
- C** Owen through his own statement
- D** Lead educator Rosa

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

collection authority

Permission established through the applicable process for someone to collect a child.

IN USE verify collection authority

authorized collector

Person whose permission to collect has been confirmed as applicable.

IN USE confirm the authorized collector

relationship claim

Statement about a relationship that may still require verification.

IN USE distinguish a relationship claim

identity verification

Process of checking that someone is who they say they are.

IN USE complete identity verification

parental responsibility

Legal responsibilities and rights whose meaning depends on the applicable jurisdiction.

IN USE clarify parental responsibility

collection arrangement

Agreed details governing a child's collection.

IN USE check the collection arrangement

usual collector

Person who ordinarily collects the child.

IN USE contact the usual collector appropriately

substitute collector

Person proposed to collect instead of the usual person.

IN USE verify a substitute collector

release

Transfer of a child into the care of an appropriately authorized person.

IN USE authorize release

supervision

Active oversight appropriate to the child and setting.

IN USE maintain supervision

sign-out record

Record of a child's departure and relevant collection details.

IN USE complete the sign-out record

visitor check

Applicable process for checking a person entering the setting.

IN USE follow the visitor check

Precision check

Identity, relationship, and collection authority are different questions. Knowing who someone is does not automatically establish permission for this collection. A child recognizing an adult is not a substitute for the applicable authorization process. Do not infer legal status from a family title.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

access control

Arrangements restricting entry to authorized people or areas.

IN USE maintain access control

safeguarding

Actions and arrangements to protect children from harm and promote welfare.

IN USE follow safeguarding procedures

designated lead

Named person with responsibility for a specified area or process.

IN USE consult the designated lead

escalation route

Defined channel for referring a concern to appropriate responsibility.

IN USE use the escalation route

confidential information

Information that requires controlled access and appropriate handling.

IN USE protect confidential information

disclosure

Sharing information with another person or organization.

IN USE limit unnecessary disclosure

verified contact route

Communication channel confirmed as appropriate for contacting the relevant person.

IN USE use a verified contact route

need-to-know basis

Limiting information access to what a person legitimately requires.

IN USE share on a need-to-know basis

legal restriction

Applicable legal limit that must be checked through the proper process.

IN USE verify a legal restriction

factual record

Account distinguishing observed facts, attributed statements, and unresolved matters.

IN USE maintain a factual record

unverified authority

Claimed permission that has not been established through the relevant process.

IN USE identify unverified authority

handover confirmation

Evidence that the authorized transfer actually occurred.

IN USE record handover confirmation

08

Precision check

Confidentiality is controlled sharing, not an unconditional promise of secrecy. Actual safeguarding duties may require information to reach appropriate people. Follow applicable local requirements and urgent procedures; this language scenario supplies neither a legal ruling nor a universal list of acceptable documents.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

WELCOME WITHOUT AUTHORIZING

"Hello. Let me check the collection arrangement with our lead educator."

NAME THE REMAINING CHECK

"Today's collection authority has not been verified yet."

NAME THE AVAILABLE LEAD

"Rosa is available to check the arrangement."

AVOID AN ACCUSATION

"I am explaining the required check, not accusing you of wrongdoing."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE STATEMENT

"You have told me you are Nia's uncle."

EXPLAIN THE BOUNDARY

"We need to complete the applicable check before any release."

KEEP SUPERVISION CLEAR

"Nia will remain under our supervision while we follow the process."

SEPARATE IDENTITY AND AUTHORITY

"Confirming identity is not the same as confirming permission for today."

08

You have told me

Attributes a relationship claim without certifying it.

Yet

Marks an incomplete check without promising approval.

Before any release

Makes the sequence and boundary clear.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PROTECT CONTACT DETAILS

"I cannot read private contact details out at the collection point."

AVOID INVENTED LEGAL CONCLUSIONS

"I cannot infer legal authority from a stated family relationship."

LIMIT THE RECORD TO FACTS

"I will record what was stated and what has actually been checked."

KEEP ESCALATION AVAILABLE

"Any concern must follow our actual safeguarding and escalation arrangements."

USE THE PROPER CONTACT ROUTE

"We will use the appropriate verified contact route."

KEEP THE OUTCOME OPEN

"The check has not produced a confirmed decision yet."

AVOID FALSE RELEASE RECORDS

"No handover has occurred, so we should not record one."

CLOSE CALMLY

"Rosa will check the arrangement; Nia has not been released."

08

Not the same as

Separates identity, relationship, and authority.

Private contact details

Names information that should not be casually disclosed.

Has not been released

States the actual child status rather than an anticipated outcome.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which opening is respectful and accurate?

- A** Hello. Let me check today's collection arrangement with Rosa.
- B** Nia recognizes you, so the family relationship is enough.
- C** Please sign out first; Rosa can confirm permission afterward.
- D** Once your identity is checked, today's permission is automatic.

08

2. What would confirming identity alone establish?

- A** Permission to collect in every circumstance
- B** A court's decision on parental responsibility
- C** That a handover has already occurred
- D** Who the person is, not necessarily today's collection authority

3. Which information should not be casually read aloud to Owen?

- A** The fact that a check is needed
- B** The fact that no release has occurred
- C** Private family contact details
- D** The fact that Rosa is available

4. Which final record fits the supplied facts?

- A** Owen's legal authority confirmed and Nia released.
- B** Owen committed an offense.
- C** Nia approved the collection and waived all checks.
- D** Owen stated he was Nia's uncle; authority unverified; Rosa available; no release.

Answers and explanations: page 99.

A collection request to verify

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

supervision / factual record / collection authority / relationship claim / confidential information / release / Identity verification / escalation route / authorized collector / collection arrangement

08

- 01 **Owen:** Hello. I am Nia's uncle. I have come instead of the person who usually collects her, and I would like to take her home.
- 02 **Lea:** Hello. Let me check the ¹ _____ with Rosa, our lead educator. She is available, and we have not verified today's collection authority yet.
- 03 **Owen:** I understand that you have not met me before. Does being unfamiliar mean you have already decided I am not allowed to collect her?
- 04 **Lea:** No. We need to verify the ² _____. I am explaining the check, not making an accusation or announcing a decision before the process is complete.
- 05 **Owen:** I have told you I am her uncle. Surely that explains why I am here, even if you have not seen me at collection before.
- 06 **Lea:** I will record that ³ _____ accurately. A stated family relationship does not, by itself, confirm identity or permission for today's collection.
- 07 **Owen:** I have identification with me. Would showing that be enough, or do you also need to confirm that I am collecting today?
- 08 **Lea:** ⁴ _____ concerns who you are. The applicable collection permission is a separate question, and we must follow our actual process for both.
- 09 **Owen:** Could you read out the family contact details so I can tell you which person to call? That might make this quicker.
- 10 **Lea:** I cannot disclose ⁵ _____ at the collection point. We will use the appropriate verified contact route and involve Rosa without sharing private details unnecessarily.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Owen:** Can Nia wait outside with me while that happens? I am asking because I do not know how long the check will take.
- 12 **Lea:** Nia needs to remain under our ⁶ _____ while we follow the process. We have not authorized a release, and I cannot give a completion time that has not been confirmed.
- 13 **Owen:** I understand Nia needs to stay with you. I do not want this written up as though I tried to take her without asking.
- 14 **Lea:** That is how the ⁷ _____ should read. It will distinguish your statement, the unverified authority, and the actions actually taken, rather than infer a legal conclusion.
- 15 **Owen:** Has Rosa actually seen the arrangement yet? I heard her name and thought perhaps she had already agreed that I could collect Nia.
- 16 **Lea:** Correct. Her availability does not make you an ⁸ _____ for today. The check still needs to establish the applicable permission, and we should not announce its outcome in advance.
- 17 **Owen:** If there is a question that you cannot resolve at the collection point, who handles it? I would prefer a clear next step.
- 18 **Lea:** Rosa will use the appropriate ⁹ _____ if needed. Any actual safeguarding concern must follow our procedures, while we keep the information accurate and the child supervised.
- 19 **Owen:** All right. Please ask Rosa to check. I will wait where you direct me while Nia stays with the staff; tell me what information you need.
- 20 **Lea:** Yes. No ¹⁰ _____ has occurred. Rosa is available to check, and we will keep the verification, supervision, and record clear while that happens.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. collection arrangement | 2. collection authority | 3. relationship claim | 4. Identity verification | 5. confidential information | 6. supervision | 7. factual record | 8. authorized collector | 9. escalation route | 10. release

Separate a family claim from collection permission

F Say it

An unfamiliar adult says she is Mia's aunt. Today's collection authority is unverified. Lead educator Noor is available to check. Mia has not been released. No legal document is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Noor / aunt / release / unverified

Educator: "The stated relationship is ¹ _____."

Colleague: "Today's collection authority is ² _____."

Educator: "The available lead is ³ _____."

Colleague: "No ⁴ _____ has occurred."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. aunt | 2. unverified | 3. Noor | 4. release

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Owen and Lea's corrected dialogue. Use a calm tone while keeping the authorization boundary clear.
2. Switch roles. Repeat the identity-check and confidential-contact exchanges without promising release or alleging wrongdoing.
3. Complete Mia's transfer, check the key, then read the aunt claim and unverified permission as separate facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Count children, confirm names

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Use a named handover to reconcile a group count without losing continuous supervision.

Fictional transition under the center's approved staffing arrangements: twelve children are attending. Eleven are with Maya and Ben; Tomas is with educator Leena after a documented bathroom handover. Leena confirms his location directly. The group stays supervised while the adults check. Tomas later returns through a confirmed handover. These numbers do not establish a staffing ratio.

PEOPLE / Maya: Early-years educator | Ben: Colleague coordinating the transition

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

name-to-face check / named handover / headcount / supervision plan / location / return handover

- 01 **Maya:** Ben, I have eleven children with the group. Today's attendance list shows twelve. Before we move inside, let us reconcile the names and the separate handover.
- 02 **Ben:** Yes. The ¹ _____ tells us how many are here, but not whether the right children are here. I will check names against faces while we maintain supervision.
- 03 **Maya:** Tomas is the name not in our gathered group. The handover record says Leena took responsibility for him for the bathroom visit. I need her direct confirmation of his current location.
- 04 **Ben:** Leena has confirmed that Tomas is with her. That is a ² _____, not a guess that somebody probably took him inside.
- 05 **Maya:** So eleven with us and one with Leena accounts for the twelve attending. We should not tick Tomas as standing here just to make our column total twelve.
- 06 **Ben:** Exactly. Keep ³ _____ and responsibility accurate. No child is unaccounted for on these confirmed facts, but that does not mean every child has already moved with this group.
- 07 **Maya:** While you check the transition record, I will stay positioned with the children as agreed. I will not leave the group to go looking for paperwork.
- 08 **Ben:** Thank you. Our ⁴ _____ still applies. The counts in this exercise do not tell us which ratios, qualifications, or individual support arrangements our real setting requires.
- 09 **Maya:** I can see each child in our group. I will confirm each name with the actual child rather than rely on a child calling out for someone else.
- 10 **Ben:** That is the ⁵ _____ we need. Two different children could leave a total unchanged, so the number alone is not a sufficient identity check.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Maya:** For the move, we will use our agreed positions and keep track of the children along the route. The check before departure is not the last check of the transition.
- 12 **Ben:** Right. We also verify the group at the destination and follow the center's procedure for checking the area left behind. None of that should leave the children without the required oversight.
- 13 **Maya:** If Leena had not confirmed Tomas's location, we would not simply deduct one and continue because the arithmetic looked tidy.
- 14 **Ben:** Correct. An unresolved discrepancy needs the immediate center response while supervision is maintained. We would not wait until the end of this conversation or ask the children to search independently.
- 15 **Maya:** Leena has now completed the return handover. I have matched Tomas by name and face and confirmed that he has rejoined us. We now have all twelve with the group.
- 16 **Ben:** Record the ⁶ _____ as a separate event. Do not prefill it from the earlier bathroom arrangement or assume return because enough time has passed.
- 17 **Maya:** I will update the location record with the actual handover details. The earlier eleven-plus-one arrangement remains part of the sequence, rather than disappearing from the record.
- 18 **Ben:** Good. Our current group count is twelve, and the names have been matched. We still keep watching, listening, and responding; an accurate record does not supervise the children for us.
- 19 **Maya:** My read-back: initially eleven with us, Tomas confirmed with Leena; now twelve reunited through the completed return handover. Current supervision responsibilities remain as agreed.
- 20 **Ben:** Confirmed. We can continue through the actual transition procedure, keeping each child's whereabouts and the receiving adult clear at every change.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. headcount | 2. named handover | 3. location | 4. supervision plan | 5. name-to-face check | 6. return handover

A split group is not an assumed absence

F Say it in a new situation

Nine children are attending under approved staffing arrangements. Seven are gathered with educators; Leena directly confirms that named children Ava and Ivo are with her in the adjoining care area. Their return handover has not occurred. The group remains supervised.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

two / seven / occurred / nine

Educator: The gathered group contains ¹ _____ children.

Colleague: Leena has confirmed responsibility for ² _____ children.

Educator: The two groups account for ³ _____ attending children.

Colleague: The return handover has not yet ⁴ _____ .

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. seven | 2. two | 3. nine | 4. occurred

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Build on the language at home

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Agree concrete language-support steps with a family while separating observed English from reported home-language skills.

Rafi joined the English-speaking preschool three weeks ago. Parent Samira reports sentences and stories in Urdu at home. Educator Anna heard him say water and more water in English and saw him use gestures. No assessment or diagnosis is supplied. They agree familiar-story support and a check-in next Friday, without withholding access to drinks or help.

PEOPLE / Samira: Rafi's parent | Anna: Early-years educator

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

10

WORD + PHRASE BANK

expressive language / code-switching / home language / family report / expansion / review date

- 01 **Samira:** At home Rafi tells us long stories in Urdu, but I hear he is quiet here. Should we stop using Urdu so he has to practice English?
- 02 **Anna:** Please keep using your ¹ _____ in the conversations and stories you enjoy. We can support English here without asking you to replace the language you share naturally.
- 03 **Samira:** Sometimes he puts an English word into an Urdu sentence. My relative says that means he is confused. I do not know what to tell them.
- 04 **Anna:** Using languages within the same exchange is often called ² _____. That example alone does not show a disorder. We need to understand the whole language picture, not judge one mixed sentence.
- 05 **Samira:** He retells a familiar story and asks his grandmother questions in Urdu. I do not want that part of his communication missed.
- 06 **Anna:** That ³ _____ is valuable. I will attribute it to you alongside my classroom observations, not claim I personally heard the Urdu stories.
- 07 **Samira:** What have you actually heard in English? Quiet makes me imagine he has not said anything all day.
- 08 **Anna:** I heard water and more water, and saw him use gestures. Those are specific examples of ⁴ _____ in English. They do not describe everything he can understand or communicate across both languages.
- 09 **Samira:** Could I bring the title of a story he already knows? He might have more to show you if he recognizes what is happening.
- 10 **Anna:** Yes. Let us use a familiar story and pictures within our activity plan. You can help us check the names and useful Urdu words rather than leave us guessing their meaning or pronunciation.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Samira:** I can show you his words for asking for help too. I want him to communicate his needs before he knows a full English sentence.
- 12 **Anna:** We will accept his available ways of communicating and model useful English. He does not have to produce a sentence to get water or assistance.
- 13 **Samira:** When he says water, should I make him repeat I would like some water, please, every time? I do not want to turn asking for a drink into a test.
- 14 **Anna:** A short ⁵ _____ can model language without a demand to repeat. For example, more water when that matches his request. Respond to the need rather than withhold the drink for a performance.
- 15 **Samira:** And if you have a real concern about his communication, please tell me specifically. I do not want everything dismissed as just learning English either.
- 16 **Anna:** Agreed. We will discuss the actual observations, including the languages and situations involved, and use the appropriate assessment or specialist route when needed. Learning English neither proves nor rules out a support need.
- 17 **Samira:** What should we each do before the next conversation? I want a manageable plan, not a promise that he will speak by a deadline.
- 18 **Anna:** Share the familiar story and check the useful words with us. I will use the supports and record specific responses. Our ⁶ _____ is next Friday, not a fluency deadline.
- 19 **Samira:** That sounds manageable. We will keep enjoying Urdu at home, and I will bring the story details. Please tell me what he communicates, not only how much English he speaks.
- 20 **Anna:** I will. At the check-in we can compare the specific examples and adjust support together, without turning three weeks in a new setting into a diagnosis or a prediction.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. home language | 2. code-switching | 3. family report | 4. expressive language | 5. expansion | 6. review date

Keep two sources visible

F Say it in a new situation

Parent Luc reports that Amelie tells stories in French at home. Educator Jo has heard help and my turn in English at preschool. They agree to share a familiar song and review the support on Tuesday. No diagnosis or fluency deadline is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Tuesday / French / English / song

10

Parent: My home-language examples are in ¹ _____.

Educator: My recorded preschool speech examples are in ² _____.

Parent: We will share a familiar ³ _____.

Educator: Our check-in is on ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. French | 2. English | 3. song | 4. Tuesday

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Preserve the child's words

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Give an immediate, factual safeguarding report without investigating, promising secrecy, or mistaking an internal handoff for completed external reporting.

Fictional England setting: Kit reports harm at 14:05. Educator Nora immediately alerts designated safeguarding lead Ravi, who begins the response. Kit stays supported and supervised. This later record review must not delay protective action or required external notification. Kit's exact words follow below.

PEOPLE / Nora: Early-years educator | Ravi: Designated safeguarding lead

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

safeguarding concern / verbatim quotation / External reporting / leading questions / chronology / promise of secrecy

11

- 01 **Nora:** Following my immediate alert, here is Kit's exact wording at fourteen oh five: I do not want to go home. Someone hurt me.
- 02 **Ravi:** The safeguarding response has begun. Keep that ¹ _____ separate from interpretation. Do not replace someone with a guessed name.
- 03 **Nora:** I listened, thanked Kit for telling me, and explained that I needed to tell someone who could help. I did not promise secrecy.
- 04 **Ravi:** That avoids a ² _____. Support the child without guaranteeing outcomes. The incomplete account still needs action.
- 05 **Nora:** Kit is supervised by the assigned educator while I report this. I have not left the child alone or asked other children for their versions.
- 06 **Ravi:** Keep the ³ _____ central. Required external notification and emergency action must not wait for a polished form or this conversation.
- 07 **Nora:** I did not ask, Did your parent do it? Kit had not named anyone. I kept the child's words without trying to establish the full story myself.
- 08 **Ravi:** Avoid ⁴ _____. Listen, report, and record accurately; do not conduct an investigation or supply missing details yourself.
- 09 **Nora:** Should I call the family myself? I normally share the day's events at collection, but this is not a routine update.
- 10 **Ravi:** Do not independently confront anyone or share details in a way that increases risk. Contact decisions follow the safeguarding response and relevant agency advice.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Nora:** For the time fields, fourteen oh five is when the child spoke. I will record the actual alert time and the later note time separately, without inventing a minute I cannot verify.
- 12 **Ravi:** Yes. The ⁵ _____ should show the sequence. If a detail is uncertain, identify that uncertainty rather than make the record appear more exact than your knowledge allows.
- 13 **Nora:** I will include the words I used in response and the actions I actually took. I will not turn my note into a diagnosis, a finding of guilt, or an explanation of motive.
- 14 **Ravi:** Exactly. Taking the child seriously and acting promptly does not require you to invent findings. Keep the factual information available to the people responsible for the protective response.
- 15 **Nora:** The room team needs to know the arrangements that affect care and supervision. Does every colleague need the child's full account in the group message?
- 16 **Ravi:** No. Use the approved secure route and share with those who need the information for protection and care. Necessary safeguarding sharing is different from circulating private details widely.
- 17 **Nora:** Your acceptance confirms that you received my concern. It does not, by itself, prove a social-care notification or any other required report has already been completed.
- 18 **Ravi:** Correct. ⁶ _____ must be carried out promptly under the applicable requirements, with the actual action recorded. No internal process overrides a person's own reporting duties.
- 19 **Nora:** If I remain worried that the concern has not been acted on, I should use the appropriate escalation route rather than assume silence means it has been resolved.
- 20 **Ravi:** Yes. Follow the actual safeguarding and escalation procedures. Keep the child supported, preserve the factual record, and do not delay necessary protective action while waiting for an internal acknowledgement.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. verbatim quotation | 2. promise of secrecy | 3. safeguarding concern | 4. leading questions | 5. chronology | 6. External reporting

Separate the report from its interpretation

F Say it in a new situation

At 10:12, Jo hears child Ari say, I am scared to go back. Jo immediately alerts safeguarding lead Leena. No person or place is identified by Ari. External notification is not confirmed in the supplied facts; protective action must not wait for this exercise.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Leena / 10:12 / confirmed / exact

11

Educator: The child's statement was heard at ¹ _____.

Lead: Keep the child's ² _____ wording in the secure record.

Educator: The named lead who received the alert is ³ _____.

Lead: External notification is not yet ⁴ _____ by these facts.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. 10:12 | 2. exact | 3. Leena | 4. confirmed

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Arrivals and family partnerships

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What did Daniel expect?

A. To stay for ten minutes

Daniel expected ten minutes, while the arrival note describes a brief goodbye.

2. Who can clarify the plan?

D. Rosa, Mina's key educator

Rosa is present and identified as the educator who can clarify the settling-in plan.

3. What is not established?

A. A fixed departure time and guaranteed emotional response

The case supplies conflicting expectations but not a completed agreement or guaranteed reaction.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which opening is most useful?

B. You expected ten minutes; the note says brief goodbye. Let us clarify the plan together.

The opening preserves both sources and invites a practical agreement without blame or a false guarantee.

2. What should be said about the cloth?

D. Its use follows the center's actual arrangements.

Arrival comfort, sleep safety, and the child's response are separate questions; familiarity does not settle all three.

3. Why should adults coordinate their wording?

D. To give Mina a calm, consistent message about the clarified plan

Consistent communication supports a clearer transition without making the child resolve an adult disagreement.

4. Which statement overreaches?

A. Mina will definitely be calm as soon as Daniel leaves.

The facts do not establish or guarantee Mina's future emotional response.

01 Conversation answers

Arrivals and family partnerships

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. settling-in plan. Turn 2. The settling-in plan is the arrangement being clarified, not a universal rule that automatically resolves the two different expectations.

2. key educator. Turn 4. The key educator is Rosa, the present staff member identified to clarify the plan with Daniel and support Mina.

3. brief goodbye. Turn 6. A brief goodbye needs a shared practical meaning here; the word alone does not specify a universal number of minutes.

4. family partnership. Turn 8. Family partnership treats Daniel's information as part of the clarification rather than assigning blame for an unresolved arrival arrangement.

5. comfort item. Turn 10. The comfort item is the familiar cloth; its use depends on actual center and safety arrangements, not an automatic permission for every situation.

6. emotional response. Turn 12. An emotional response cannot be promised in advance; Rosa can support Mina without guaranteeing a specific reaction to separation.

7. arrival routine. Turn 14. The arrival routine is the understandable sequence adults clarify for Mina, not a promise that every morning will feel identical.

8. shared understanding. Turn 16. Shared understanding means the practical agreement is clear to the adults, rather than relying on the unresolved word brief.

9. update arrangement. Turn 18. An update arrangement specifies actual later communication; it must be agreed rather than assumed or offered as an unsupported timing guarantee.

10. consistency. Turn 20. Consistency aligns the adults' messages after clarification, helping Mina receive one coherent plan without an invented departure deadline.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. five-minute

Ellis: "I expected a five-minute stay."

The parent expectation is a five-minute stay, not an agreed revision.

2. immediate handover

Noor: "The note says immediate handover."

Immediate handover is the wording in the existing note.

3. Noor

Ellis: "The key educator available is Noor."

Noor is the present educator identified to clarify the arrangement.

4. confirmed

Noor: "The revised agreement is not yet confirmed."

No revised arrangement has been agreed in the supplied facts.

02 Briefing and language checks

Play-based learning and useful prompts

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What does Eva want?

D. A wider bridge

Eva's stated priority is the width of the bridge.

2. What does Jo want?

D. A taller opening underneath

Jo's stated priority is the height of the opening underneath.

3. What can the educators suggest?

D. Try two designs using the available blocks.

The brief allows two designs with available blocks but supplies no winner or outcome.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which prompt preserves Jo's idea?

D. Show us where you want the taller opening.

The prompt preserves opening height as Jo's priority without supplying a design or ranking.

2. Which sentence is a leading question?

B. Wouldn't it be better to use my wider design?

The question embeds the adult preferred answer instead of inviting the child's own explanation.

3. Which comparison is factual in principle?

A. This bridge is wider, while that opening is taller.

Width and opening height can be described separately without ranking children or inventing results.

4. What is the proposed next action?

C. Try two designs using available blocks.

The stated opportunity is a feasible comparison, not a guaranteed result or predetermined competition.

02 Conversation answers

Play-based learning and useful prompts

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. design intention.** Turn 2. Design intention identifies what each child wants the structure to achieve, so the two different priorities can be heard before choosing a trial.
- 2. open prompt.** Turn 4. An open prompt invites Eva's meaning through words or demonstration instead of supplying the adult's preferred design.
- 3. spatial language.** Turn 6. Spatial language identifies the opening underneath the bridge and helps preserve the location relevant to Jo's proposal.
- 4. leading question.** Turn 8. A leading question contains an implied preferred answer, here favoring the wider design before the children's ideas are explored.
- 5. trial.** Turn 10. A trial is an attempt to explore a design; proposing two trials does not establish either outcome or a winner.
- 6. specific feedback.** Turn 12. Specific feedback names an observed action or feature, giving useful language without replacing the child's idea with general praise or ranking.
- 7. Comparative language.** Turn 14. Comparative language describes relative qualities such as width and height, not an automatic judgment that one child or design is better.
- 8. expansion.** Turn 16. Expansion adds language to the child's expressed meaning while preserving the intention rather than substituting an adult idea.
- 9. wait time.** Turn 18. Wait time leaves room for processing and response; answering immediately for the children would remove that opportunity.
- 10. collaborative play.** Turn 20. Collaborative play involves shared exploration and coordination, which the two-design comparison supports without a predetermined winner.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. wider

Educator: "Ari wants a wider base."

Ari's stated intention concerns the width of the base.

2. taller

Colleague: "Bea wants a taller tower."

Bea's stated intention concerns the height of the tower.

3. trials

Educator: "We can offer two trials."

The available blocks allow two exploratory trials of the ideas.

4. winner

Colleague: "No winner has been chosen."

The facts do not establish a winner before exploration.

03 Briefing and language checks

Daily routines and supported transitions

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which timing statement is supplied by the arrangement?

C. Story time begins in five minutes.

Five minutes is the warning before story time, not a return promise or an extension triggered by the finishing choice.

2. What can remain on the marked shelf?

C. Luca's structure under the current arrangement

The current arrangement specifically permits the structure to remain on the marked shelf.

3. What do the two choices concern?

A. How Luca finishes before the transition

The last block or permitted photograph supports finishing within the existing boundary.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which child-facing message matches the arrangement?

A. Story time is in five minutes; choose the last block or a permitted photograph before we move.

The message combines the supplied warning, available finishing choices, and actual transition boundary.

2. Which statement about the structure is supported?

B. It can remain on the marked shelf under the current arrangement.

The brief permits the marked shelf but does not create unlimited storage or safety permission.

3. Which photography action is inappropriate?

D. Use an unapproved personal phone because the picture would help.

A transition benefit does not authorize an unapproved device or override image-handling requirements.

4. What should remain with the adults?

B. Responsibility for supervision during the transition

Giving choices does not transfer supervision responsibility from staff to the child.

03 Conversation answers

Daily routines and supported transitions

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. advance warning. Turn 2. Advance warning tells Luca about the five-minute change before it occurs, supporting preparation rather than a sudden instruction.

2. preserved work. Turn 4. Preserved work means the structure can remain under the current arrangement; it does not imply unlimited play or a promised return time.

3. bounded choice. Turn 6. A bounded choice offers two genuinely available ways to finish while the move to story time remains fixed.

4. nonnegotiable boundary. Turn 8. The nonnegotiable boundary is the move to story time, distinct from Luca's available choice of a finishing action.

5. first-then language. Turn 10. First-then language makes the sequence explicit: the finishing step precedes the move to the next activity.

6. photography permission. Turn 12. Photography permission and the center's actual arrangements govern the image; a helpful transition idea does not authorize any device or use.

7. return expectation. Turn 14. The return expectation must not include an invented time; preserving the structure does not establish when building will resume.

8. processing time. Turn 16. Processing time lets Luca understand and respond to the available choices rather than face a changing or rushed instruction.

9. Supervision continuity. Turn 18. Supervision continuity keeps appropriate adult oversight in place through the transition; the child does not assume that responsibility.

10. consistent cue. Turn 20. A consistent cue aligns the adults' transition message so Luca hears the same sequence and available choices.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. three

Educator: "Music begins in three minutes."

The scenario gives a three-minute warning before music begins.

2. tray

Ari: "My drawing can stay in the named tray."

The permitted storage location is the named tray.

3. line

Educator: "You can add one final line."

Adding one final line is one of the available finishing choices.

4. label

Ari: "Or I can ask you to label the work."

Asking the educator to label the work is the second supplied choice.



04 Briefing and language checks

Co-regulation and peer disagreements

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What did Sora directly observe?

A. Ari holding the large scoop, then Bea reaching toward it

Only the holding and reaching sequence is observed; motives and outcomes are not established.

2. What does Ari want to finish?

B. One container

Ari's stated finishing point is one container, not an unlimited period.

3. Which additional resource is available?

B. A smaller scoop

The brief provides a smaller scoop, which may be offered without pretending it is identical.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which account avoids an unsupported motive?

B. Ari held the large scoop; Bea then reached toward it.

The correct account preserves the observed sequence without adding intention or a fixed label.

2. Which proposal uses the supplied facts?

A. Ari finishes one container, then Bea has the next supported turn; the smaller scoop is available meanwhile.

The proposal uses the stated finishing point, next-turn request, and actual alternative without inventing resources or timing.

3. What does emotional validation mean here?

D. Acknowledge wanting the scoop without approving every action used to obtain it.

Acknowledging the wish can coexist with boundaries and practical support for access.

4. What remains necessary after proposing the sequence?

B. Support understanding and remain responsive to the actual interaction.

A proposed sequence does not prove acceptance or remove the need for adult support.

04 Conversation answers

Co-regulation and peer disagreements

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. observed sequence. Turn 2. The observed sequence is Ari holding the large scoop followed by Bea reaching toward it; it does not establish a motive.

2. inferred motive. Turn 4. An inferred motive is an assumed reason for the behavior, unlike the directly observed holding and reaching.

3. finishing point. Turn 6. The finishing point is one container, a specific stated limit rather than unlimited use or an invented number of minutes.

4. neutral description. Turn 8. A neutral description names current use and the next request without judging the children or claiming to know their intentions.

5. alternative resource. Turn 10. The alternative resource is the smaller scoop, which can be offered honestly without claiming it is an identical replacement.

6. emotional validation. Turn 12. Emotional validation acknowledges the wish or feeling while allowing adults to maintain a clear boundary and support appropriate access.

7. turn-taking. Turn 14. Turn-taking organizes access through an understandable sequence rather than a vague instruction to share or an unlimited possession claim.

8. next turn. Turn 16. The next turn follows the supplied finishing point, not an invented time limit or a guaranteed immediate transfer.

9. co-regulation. Turn 18. Co-regulation combines supportive adult interaction and clear structure while the child develops ways to manage the disagreement.

10. agreement check. Turn 20. An agreement check establishes whether the proposed sequence has been understood or accepted rather than assuming completion from an adult announcement.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. red

Educator: "Noor is using the red truck."

The red truck is the object currently being used.

2. route

Colleague: "The finishing point is one route."

Noor's stated finishing point is one route, not unlimited time.

3. blue

Educator: "A blue truck is available meanwhile."

The available alternative is a blue truck, not another red one.

4. unknown

Colleague: "The motive for reaching is unknown."

The observation establishes reaching but not the reason for it.

05 Briefing and language checks

Observation and family progress conversations

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What did Rosa observe?

B. Eli sorting four buttons by color during a supervised activity

The observed action involves four buttons and color sorting, not a comparative assessment.

2. Which words belong inside quotation marks in Rosa's note?

B. These go together.

Only These go together was heard; the other sentences add wording or skills that Rosa did not record.

3. What evidence is missing for the parent's claim?

B. Appropriate comparison data and broader assessment

A universal age-peer ranking requires evidence that this single observation does not provide.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which message is both warm and accurate?

A. Eli grouped four buttons by color and said, "These go together"; I wanted to share that moment.

The message celebrates the specific observed action and quotation without a broader unsupported ranking.

2. Which skill is not established just by the described sorting?

B. Counting the four objects accurately

Four objects being present does not prove that Eli counted them or understood cardinality.

3. What would a precise note include?

B. Action, exact words where quoted, context, and observation date

These details preserve the evidence so it can be understood in its actual context.

4. How should a home example be handled?

D. Keep it attributed to the family and distinct from Rosa's observation.

Family information can be useful while its source remains accurately identified.

05 Conversation answers

Observation and family progress conversations

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. observation record. Turn 2. The observation record describes today's event, not Eli's rank among all same-age children.

2. sorting criterion. Turn 4. The sorting criterion was color, the feature Eli used to group the buttons in the observed activity.

3. strength-based description. Turn 6. A strength-based description recognizes Eli's observed capability without exaggerating it into an unsupported peer comparison.

4. Classification. Turn 8. Classification groups items by a shared feature; it does not establish counting or understanding quantity.

5. Developmental screening. Turn 10. Developmental screening identifies possible evaluation needs through a structured process, unlike this single observation.

6. comparison group. Turn 12. A comparison group provides a basis for comparative interpretation, which is absent from the parent's universal ranking claim.

7. verbatim quotation. Turn 14. A verbatim quotation retains Eli's exact words, not a more elaborate invented statement.

8. context. Turn 16. Context preserves each event's setting; the family's home report remains distinct from Rosa's observation.

9. developmental domains. Turn 18. Developmental domains concern different areas of development; one sorting observation cannot establish performance across them.

10. anecdotal note. Turn 20. An anecdotal note preserves an event's action, words, and context without claiming a full developmental assessment.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. shape

Noor: "The grouping feature was shape."

The observed grouping criterion is shape rather than color.

2. three

Parent: "There were three large shapes."

Three is the number of objects supplied in the activity.

3. same

Noor: "Ari said, These are the same."

Same completes the exact quotation supplied in the brief.

4. comparison

Parent: "No peer comparison is established."

The observation supplies no evidence for a peer ranking.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Inclusive participation and home languages

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. Which response formats does the plan allow?

A. Picture choices or spoken answers

Noor's current plan explicitly allows both picture choices and spoken answers.

2. What does Noor prefer today?

B. Pointing

The stated preference is pointing, not an inferred reason or diagnosis.

3. What should the team avoid claiming?

D. That pointing supplies identical evidence to a spoken sentence

Different formats can support participation while providing different evidence of expressive spoken language.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which note is most accurate?

B. Noor participated by selecting a picture through pointing; no spoken sentence was recorded.

The note preserves the permitted participation and the actual response mode without inventing speech or diagnosis.

2. Which action conflicts with the current plan?

B. Require spoken answers as the only way to count participation.

The plan allows picture choices, so an unannounced speech-only rule removes a permitted route.

3. What can be inferred about the home language?

D. Nothing specific from the supplied pointing preference alone

The case supplies no home-language profile, and a single response does not establish one.

4. Which distinction matters?

B. Participation can be valid while evidence of spoken-language production remains limited.

Inclusive access and precise assessment can coexist without false equivalence between response modes.

06 Conversation answers

Inclusive participation and home languages

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. inclusion plan. Turn 2. The inclusion plan explicitly permits picture choices or spoken answers, so speech is not the only allowed participation route.

2. participation. Turn 4. Participation means taking part through an appropriate available form; here a permitted pointing response can count without spoken language.

3. response mode. Turn 6. The response mode records how Noor answered, preserving pointing as distinct from a spoken sentence.

4. evidence limit. Turn 8. The evidence limit prevents an allowed pointing response from being treated as proof of spoken-language production that did not occur.

5. language difference. Turn 10. A language difference and a developmental concern require appropriate contextual information; Noor's single pointing preference establishes neither.

6. Family language information. Turn 12. Family language information comes from appropriate sources and retains its context; it cannot be invented from a response preference or name.

7. access barrier. Turn 14. An access barrier would arise from excluding the picture-choice route that Noor's plan currently permits for this activity.

8. expressive language. Turn 16. Expressive language concerns conveying meaning; the record must identify the actual form rather than invent a spoken sentence or erase other communication.

9. visual support. Turn 18. Visual support must be usable within the activity; merely listing picture choices in a plan does not make them practically accessible.

10. equitable opportunity. Turn 20. Equitable opportunity can involve different supports while preserving accurate evidence about how each child participated.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. picture

Educator: "The selected response used a picture."

Ari selected a picture under the current permitted arrangement.

2. recorded

Colleague: "A spoken answer was not recorded."

No spoken answer is supplied in this observation.

3. plan

Educator: "The choice was allowed by the current plan."

The plan permits either the spoken or picture response.

4. unspecified

Colleague: "The home-language profile remains unspecified."

No home-language information is supplied by this particular observation.

07 Briefing and language checks

Health records and factual incident handovers

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What does Morgan report?

C. The allergy plan may have changed.

The report concerns a possible plan change, not a completed revision or an exposure.

2. Which status is established when Amira accepts the document query?

D. The question has a named receiving owner.

Amira accepts ownership of the query; verification, version replacement, and staff communication are not yet established.

3. What remains unavailable?

C. The revised document

No revised document is supplied, so its contents cannot be treated as verified.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which handoff is accurate?

D. Parent reports a possible plan change; earlier plan held; revision unavailable; Amira accepts the query.

The handoff preserves the report, document gap, and receiving owner without inventing a care event or completion.

2. What does Amira accepting the query establish?

A. The document question has a receiving owner.

Acceptance assigns the query but does not complete all subsequent verification and communication.

3. Which statement is unsafe as a general inference?

D. No revised paper means the reported concern can be ignored.

A missing document does not remove the need to address a reported health concern through the appropriate process.

4. What should not be added to the incident record for this case?

A. An invented exposure, symptom, or treatment

The case explicitly supplies no exposure, symptoms, or treatment event, so recording one would be false.

07 Conversation answers

Health records and factual incident handovers

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. reported change. Turn 2. The reported change preserves Morgan's information as a possible update, not as a verified revision or an irrelevant comment.

2. unresolved query. Turn 4. The unresolved query concerns the possible change and missing revision; holding an earlier document does not settle its implications.

3. parent report. Turn 6. The parent report must retain Morgan's wording and uncertainty rather than become a confirmed new clinical instruction.

4. health coordinator. Turn 8. The health coordinator is the named receiving owner who is present and has accepted this document question.

5. incident record. Turn 10. An incident record must contain actual reported or observed events; this conversation does not supply an exposure, reaction, or treatment.

6. document control. Turn 12. Document control preserves the status and version of the available plan and the unresolved revision, rather than silently substituting an assumed update.

7. verified revision. Turn 14. A verified revision requires the appropriate source and process; rewriting from memory would not establish an authorized update.

8. handoff acknowledgment. Turn 16. Handoff acknowledgment confirms Amira accepted the question, not that the revised plan or staff communication is complete.

9. staff briefing. Turn 18. A staff briefing must actually occur through the appropriate process before being recorded as completed; it is not implied by the first handoff.

10. allergy action plan. Turn 20. The allergy action plan requires appropriate verification of its applicable instructions; this conversation establishes the query and handoff, not a replacement plan.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. unavailable

Educator: "The revised document is unavailable."

The revised version has not been supplied in this scenario.

2. held

Parent: "The earlier document is still held."

The center still holds the earlier document, not a verified replacement.

3. Noor

Educator: "The receiving coordinator is Noor."

Noor explicitly accepts this document query as the receiving owner.

4. symptoms

Parent: "No symptoms were reported in this conversation."

The scenario supplies no symptom report and none should be invented.

08 Briefing and language checks

Collection, confidentiality, and safeguarding communication

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What does Owen state?

A. He is Nia's uncle and has come to collect her.

Owen states a relationship and purpose, but neither has been verified in this conversation.

2. What is Nia's current status?

D. She has not been released.

The brief explicitly says Nia has not been released.

3. Who is available to check the arrangement?

D. Lead educator Rosa

Rosa is the available lead educator for checking the arrangement.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which opening is respectful and accurate?

A. Hello. Let me check today's collection arrangement with Rosa.

The opening preserves today's authorization check; recognition, identity, and a sign-out entry cannot replace it.

2. What would confirming identity alone establish?

D. Who the person is, not necessarily today's collection authority

Identity verification does not by itself establish the separate authorization or legal questions.

3. Which information should not be casually read aloud to Owen?

C. Private family contact details

The request does not authorize unnecessary disclosure of confidential family contact information.

4. Which final record fits the supplied facts?

D. Owen stated he was Nia's uncle; authority unverified; Rosa available; no release.

The factual record preserves the attributed statement and actual status without inventing approval, wrongdoing, or release.

08 Conversation answers

Collection, confidentiality, and safeguarding communication

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. collection arrangement.** Turn 2. The collection arrangement must be checked through the actual process; Owen's stated relationship does not establish today's permission.
- 2. collection authority.** Turn 4. Collection authority concerns permission for this collection; unfamiliarity is not itself a completed decision or accusation.
- 3. relationship claim.** Turn 6. The relationship claim is attributed to Owen; it does not independently verify identity, legal status, or permission to collect.
- 4. Identity verification.** Turn 8. Identity verification establishes who someone is through the appropriate process, not every separate question of collection authorization.
- 5. confidential information.** Turn 10. Confidential information must be protected; an unverified collection request does not justify reading private family contacts aloud.
- 6. supervision.** Turn 12. Supervision remains with the setting while the collection authority is unverified; waiting outside with Owen would bypass that boundary.
- 7. factual record.** Turn 14. The factual record distinguishes Owen's statement, unverified authority, and actual actions without inventing a release or wrongdoing.
- 8. authorized collector.** Turn 16. An authorized collector has applicable permission confirmed through the proper process; the lead educator's availability alone establishes no approval.
- 9. escalation route.** Turn 18. The escalation route sends an unresolved concern to the responsible people under the setting's actual procedures, not an invented universal rule.
- 10. release.** Turn 20. Release means the authorized transfer of the child; none has occurred while today's collection authority remains unverified.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. aunt

Educator: "The stated relationship is aunt."

The adult claims to be Mia's aunt, but this remains an attributed statement.

2. unverified

Colleague: "Today's collection authority is unverified."

The supplied facts do not establish confirmed authority for this collection.

3. Noor

Educator: "The available lead is Noor."

Noor is explicitly named as available to check the arrangement.

4. release

Colleague: "No release has occurred."

Mia has not been released under the facts supplied here.

08

09 Conversation answers

Count children, confirm names

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. headcount. Turn 2. The headcount is eleven in the gathered group, while twelve children are attending; the difference must be reconciled through actual named information.

2. named handover. Turn 4. The handover identifies Tomas and Leena, with direct confirmation of current responsibility; a vague assumption that someone took a child would not establish this.

3. location. Turn 6. Tomas is currently with Leena, not in the eleven-child group; the record must preserve where each child actually is.

4. supervision plan. Turn 8. The approved supervision plan allocates adult attention and positions during the transition; paperwork and a correct total do not replace that continuous oversight.

5. name-to-face check. Turn 10. A name-to-face check visually matches each child with the relevant name; hearing a reply or reaching the expected total alone is not equivalent.

6. return handover. Turn 16. The return handover establishes that Tomas has actually rejoined the group; the earlier record of Leena taking responsibility did not prove his return.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. seven

Educator: The gathered group contains seven children.

Seven children are physically in the gathered group; the total attendance of nine is a different count.

2. two

Colleague: Leena has confirmed responsibility for two children.

Ava and Ivo are two named children whose separate location and adult responsibility have been directly confirmed.

3. nine

Educator: The two groups account for nine attending children.

Seven gathered children plus the two confirmed with Leena equals all nine attending children.

4. occurred

Colleague: The return handover has not yet occurred .

The facts confirm the separate care arrangement, not a completed return to the gathered group.

Background reading: [Office of Head Start: active supervision and name-to-face checks](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

Build on the language at home

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. home language. Turn 2. Urdu is the language Samira reports using with Rafi at home; supporting English does not require abandoning that family language.

2. code-switching. Turn 4. Code-switching means moving between languages within communication; the mixed-language example alone does not establish confusion or a disorder.

3. family report. Turn 6. Samira's account supplies information about Urdu use at home; Anna should attribute it to the family rather than record it as her own classroom observation.

4. expressive language. Turn 8. Expressive language conveys meaning; Anna's observed English examples should be recorded specifically rather than replaced by the broad label quiet or a claim of fluent sentences.

5. expansion. Turn 14. An expansion adds language while preserving the child's meaning; modeling more water does not require withholding the drink until Rafi repeats a prescribed sentence.

6. review date. Turn 18. Next Friday is the agreed check-in date to review observations and supports, not a deadline by which Rafi must achieve a specified level of English.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. French

Parent: My home-language examples are in French .

Luc reports French storytelling at home; that information should not be relabeled as observed English at preschool.

2. English

Educator: My recorded preschool speech examples are in English .

Jo heard help and my turn in English; those observations are distinct from Luc's home report.

3. song

Parent: We will share a familiar song .

The agreed support is a familiar song, not an invented assessment score or treatment.

4. Tuesday

Educator: Our check-in is on Tuesday .

Tuesday is the review date for support, not a promise that Amelie will become fluent by then.

10

Background reading: [ASHA: learning more than one language and language-support concerns](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

Preserve the child's words

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

- 1. verbatim quotation.** Turn 2. The quotation preserves Kit's actual words; replacing someone with a guessed person's name would add information Kit did not supply.
- 2. promise of secrecy.** Turn 4. A promise of secrecy would conflict with necessary protective information sharing; Nora instead explained that an appropriate person needed to help.
- 3. safeguarding concern.** Turn 6. Kit's words raise a safeguarding concern requiring the actual protective response; an incomplete account is not a reason to postpone action until more proof is collected.
- 4. leading questions.** Turn 8. A question suggesting a named person or expected event can shape the account; Nora should not conduct an investigation or supply missing details.
- 5. chronology.** Turn 12. Chronology distinguishes when Kit spoke, when Nora alerted Ravi, and when the note was made; those separate events should not be collapsed into one invented timestamp.
- 6. External reporting.** Turn 18. External reporting involves the required notification beyond the setting; Ravi receiving Nora's internal alert does not itself establish that this separate action has occurred.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. 10:12

Educator: The child's statement was heard at 10:12 .

10:12 is the stated time of Ari's words, not an invented time for every later action.

2. exact

Lead: Keep the child's exact wording in the secure record.

Exact wording preserves I am scared to go back without supplying a person or place Ari did not identify.

3. Leena

Educator: The named lead who received the alert is Leena .

Leena is the explicitly identified safeguarding lead, distinct from an unnamed external recipient.

4. confirmed

Lead: External notification is not yet confirmed by these facts.

An internal alert establishes receipt within the setting, not completion of a separate required external notification.

11

Background reading: [NSPCC: responding to disclosures and recording concerns](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Arrivals and family partnerships

Acknowledge the expectation: You expected to stay for ten minutes.

Identify the responsible adult: I am Mina's key educator, and we can clarify the plan.

Notice the familiar item: Mina has brought her familiar cloth.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Play-based learning and useful prompts

Invite Eva's idea: Eva, show us what you mean by a wider bridge.

Avoid a winner: We have two ideas to try, not a winner already chosen.

Allow processing: I will pause so each child has time to respond.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Daily routines and supported transitions

Give advance notice: Story time begins in five minutes.

Show the storage place: Your structure can stay on the marked shelf.

Preserve the work: We do not need to dismantle the structure for this transition.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Co-regulation and peer disagreements

Describe what was seen: I saw Ari holding the large scoop and Bea reaching toward it.

Name current use: Ari is using the large scoop now.

Do not pretend equivalence: The smaller scoop is an option, not an identical replacement.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Observation and family progress conversations

Share the observation: Today I saw Eli sort four buttons by color.

Celebrate specifically: I wanted to share the way Eli grouped the colors.

Identify the criterion: Color was the feature used to group the buttons.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Inclusive participation and home languages

Refer to the plan: Noor's current plan allows picture choices or spoken answers.

State the observation: Noor selected a picture by pointing.

Reject a guessed diagnosis: This response alone does not establish a language delay.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Health records and factual incident handovers

Acknowledge the report: Thank you for telling me the plan may have changed.

Preserve uncertainty: I will record this as a reported possible change.

Do not dismiss the report: The missing document does not mean we should ignore what you have told us.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Collection, confidentiality, and safeguarding communication

Welcome without authorizing: Hello. Let me check the collection arrangement with our lead educator.

Explain the boundary: We need to complete the applicable check before any release.

Separate identity and authority: Confirming identity is not the same as confirming permission for today.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

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access barrier identify an access barrier	51
access control maintain access control	69
adult modeling use adult modeling	33
adult scaffolding provide adult scaffolding	14
advance warning give advance warning	23
agreed wording use agreed wording	6
agreement check make an agreement check	33
allergen identify the relevant allergen	60
allergic reaction recognize an allergic reaction	60
allergy action plan verify the allergy action plan	59
alternative communication support alternative communication	51
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anaphylaxis follow anaphylaxis procedures	60
anecdotal note write an anecdotal note	41
approved device use an approved device	24
arrival note review the arrival note	6
arrival routine establish an arrival routine	5
attachment support attachment relationships	5
attribute name an attribute	41
augmentative communication use appropriate augmentative communication	51
authorized collector confirm the authorized collector	68
bounded choice offer a bounded choice	23
brief goodbye agree on a brief goodbye	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

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cardinality explore cardinality	41
care instruction clarify a care instruction	59
child cue notice a child cue	6
child-led idea follow a child-led idea	14
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collection arrangement check the collection arrangement	68
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comfort item check comfort-item arrangements	5
communication access provide communication access	50
comparative language model comparative language	14
comparison group identify the comparison group	42
confidential information protect confidential information	69
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consistency maintain consistency	6
consistent cue agree on a consistent cue	24
contact preference confirm contact preferences	6
context record the context	41
criterion-referenced measure use a criterion-referenced measure	42
cross-contact prevent allergen cross-contact	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

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current version confirm the current version	59
design intention clarify the design intention	15
designated lead consult the designated lead	69
developmental domain distinguish developmental domains	42
developmental milestone discuss a developmental milestone	42
developmental screening distinguish developmental screening	42
diagnostic assessment refer for diagnostic assessment	42
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document control follow document control	59
dual language learner support a dual language learner	51
emergency action plan follow the emergency action plan	59
emotion vocabulary model emotion vocabulary	33
emotional response observe the emotional response	6
emotional validation offer emotional validation	32
engagement observe engagement	50
equitable opportunity provide equitable opportunity	51
escalation route use the escalation route	69
evidence limit state the evidence limit	51
expansion offer a language expansion	14
exposure record a reported exposure	60
expressive language support expressive language	50
factual record maintain a factual record	69
familiar object discuss a familiar object	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

family language information	gather family language information	51
family partnership	build a family partnership	5
fine-motor skill	observe fine-motor skills	41
finishing point	identify a finishing point	23
finishing point	agree a finishing point	32
first-then language	use first-then language	23
follow-through	provide calm follow-through	24
food intolerance	distinguish food intolerance	60
forced apology	distinguish repair from a forced apology	33
formative assessment	use formative assessment	42
gesture	notice a gesture	50
group movement	support group movement	24
handoff acknowledgment	obtain handoff acknowledgment	60
handover	complete the morning handover	5
handover confirmation	record handover confirmation	69
health coordinator	contact the health coordinator	59
healthcare plan	review the healthcare plan	59
height	compare opening height	15
home language	value the home language	51
identity verification	complete identity verification	68
image storage	follow image-storage rules	24
impulse	support impulse management	33
incident record	complete an incident record	60
inclusion plan	follow the inclusion plan	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

individual need respond to individual needs	6
inferred motive avoid an inferred motive	32
key educator speak with the key educator	5
language delay refer a language-delay concern	51
language difference distinguish a language difference	51
last step name the last step	23
leading question avoid a leading question	14
learning story develop a learning story	41
legal restriction verify a legal restriction	69
marked shelf use the marked shelf	23
medication authorization verify medication authorization	60
modeling use language modeling	14
multilingual repertoire recognize a multilingual repertoire	51
need-to-know basis share on a need-to-know basis	69
negotiable detail identify the negotiable detail	24
neutral description use a neutral description	32
next turn clarify the next turn	32
nonnegotiable boundary state the nonnegotiable boundary	24
norm-referenced measure interpret a norm-referenced measure	42
observation record create an observation record	41
observed sequence preserve the observed sequence	32
one-to-one correspondence observe one-to-one correspondence	41
open prompt use an open prompt	14
parent expectation clarify the parent expectation	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

parent report preserve the parent report	59
parental responsibility clarify parental responsibility	68
participation recognize participation	50
peer interaction observe peer interaction	33
perspective-taking support perspective-taking	33
photography permission verify photography permission	23
picture choice offer picture choices	50
play-based learning support play-based learning	14
pointing response acknowledge a pointing response	50
predictability build predictability	6
predictable routine maintain a predictable routine	23
prediction make a prediction	15
preserved work protect preserved work	23
processing time allow processing time	24
reassurance offer realistic reassurance	5
recasting use a gentle recast	14
receptive language distinguish receptive language	50
reciprocity encourage reciprocity	33
relationship claim distinguish a relationship claim	68
release authorize release	68
reliability examine reliability	42
repair support an appropriate repair	33
reported change record a reported change	59
resource conflict mediate a resource conflict	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

response mode	record the response mode	50
responsive care	provide responsive care	5
return expectation	clarify the return expectation	24
revision	revise the design	15
rushed instruction	avoid a rushed instruction	24
safeguarding	follow safeguarding procedures	69
self-regulation	support self-regulation	32
separation	support separation	5
settling-in plan	clarify the settling-in plan	5
shared understanding	establish shared understanding	6
sign-out record	complete the sign-out record	68
sorting criterion	identify the sorting criterion	41
source document	request the source document	59
span	compare the span	15
spatial language	introduce spatial language	14
specific feedback	give specific feedback	15
spoken response	record a spoken response	50
stability	explore stability	15
staff briefing	document the staff briefing	60
strength-based description	use a strength-based description	42
substitute collector	verify a substitute collector	68
summative assessment	distinguish summative assessment	42
superseded version	identify a superseded version	59
supervision	maintain supervision	68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

supervision continuity	preserve supervision continuity	24
support	position the supports	15
sustained shared thinking	support sustained shared thinking	14
training record	check the training record	60
transition	support a transition	23
transition cue	use a transition cue	23
transition support	provide transition support	6
trial	compare two trials	15
turn-taking	support turn-taking	32
unresolved query	track the unresolved query	60
unverified authority	identify unverified authority	69
update arrangement	clarify the update arrangement	6
usual collector	contact the usual collector appropriately	68
validity	examine validity	42
verbatim quotation	preserve a verbatim quotation	41
verified contact route	use a verified contact route	69
verified revision	obtain a verified revision	59
visitor check	follow the visitor check	68
visual schedule	refer to the visual schedule	23
visual support	use visual supports	50
wait time	allow wait time	14
waiting option	offer a waiting option	32
width	compare bridge width	15
work sample	collect a work sample	41

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] Department for Education. Early Years Foundation Stage Statutory Framework.

[Open the original source](#)

England framework updated September 2026. Context for family communication, health information, confidentiality, and collection procedures; not a universal legal code. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] NAEYC. Observing, Documenting, and Assessing Children's Development and Learning.

[Open the original source](#)

Professional context for responsive observation and appropriate use of assessment evidence. Original cases do not establish developmental diagnoses or rankings. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] Office of Head Start. Home Language Support.

[Open the original source](#)

Developmental background on supporting home languages alongside English. The fictional participation plan is specific to the child and activity. Checked 10 October 2026.

[4] Rosanbalm and Murray. Co-Regulation From Birth Through Young Adulthood: A Practice Brief.

[Open the original source](#)

Research-to-practice context for supportive relationships, predictable environments, and coaching. The original peer scenarios are language practice, not behavior-treatment protocols. Checked 10 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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